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## **Report Name:** Oilseeds and Products Annual

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### **Report Highlights:**

Marketing Year (MY) 2025/26 European Union oilseed production is forecast to rebound from low production levels in MY 2024/25 due to better growing conditions; higher, more average yields; and increases in area harvested. Feed use of oilseed meals is forecast to marginally decline as oilseed products face price competition from feed grains. MY 2025/26 oilseed imports are anticipated to decline as better domestic harvests meet more of local demand. Food use of vegetable oils is forecast to rebound from low-supply conditions in MY 2024/25. The postponed EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) comes into force at the end of 2025, and will likely impact the overall dynamics of the oilseeds market particularly for soybean products and palm oil. The Russian invasion of Ukraine continues to bring uncertainty.

## Introduction

This report presents the outlook for oilseeds in the EU. The data in this report is based on the views of Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS) analysts in the EU and is not official USDA data.

## Disclaimer / Important Notes:

- USDA official numbers in this report include the World Agricultural Supply and Demand Estimates (WASDE) March 2025 release.
- In this report the term "biofuel" includes only biofuels used in the transport sector. Biomass/biofuel used for electricity production or other technical uses such as lubricants or in detergents are included in "industrial use."
- Trade figures are revised according to the most recent data available from Trade Data Monitor (December 2024, Olive Oil: January 2025).
- The term European Union (EU) refers to the current [EU27 member states](#).

This report was a group effort of the following FAS analysts:

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Denys Sobolev, FAS/Kiev covering Ukraine

Also, the FAS EU oilseeds reporting team would like to thank the FAS/GMA Washington team for their valuable input and support.

The marketing years (MY) used in this report are:

January - December

Copra complex

Palm kernel complex

Palm oil

Fish meal

July - June

Rapeseed complex

October - September

Soybean complex

Sunflower complex

Cottonseed complex

Peanut complex

November - October

Olive oil

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## 1. Executive Summary / Total Oilseeds

Please find the details for specific commodities in their respective sections of this report.

Note: Total oilseeds include different MYs with different beginning and ending months.

### Total Oilseeds – Seeds

**Table 1: Oilseeds, Total Oilseeds – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

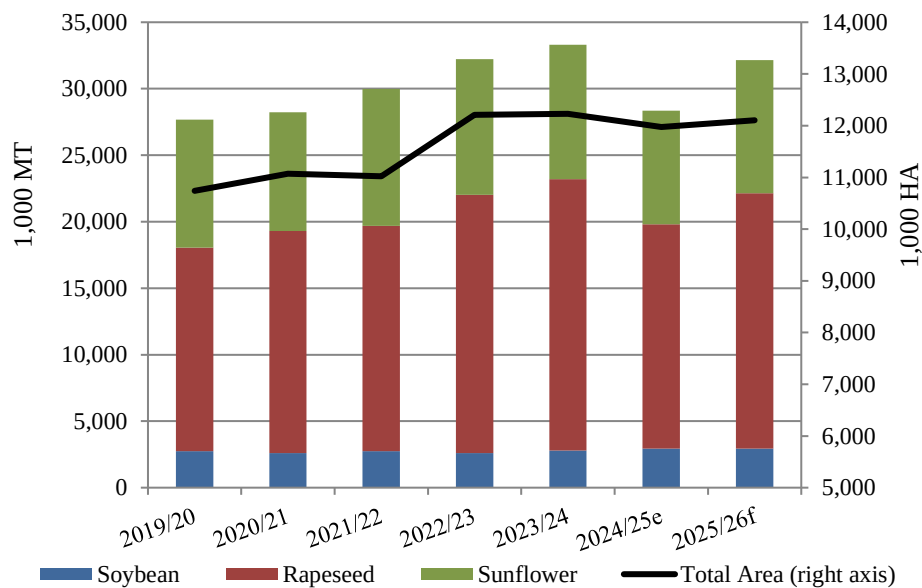
| Oilseeds, Total Oilseeds     | 2023/24       |          | 2024/25       |          | 2025/26       |          |
|------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
|                              | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>European Union</b>        |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| <b>Area Harvested</b>        | 12,289        | 12,229   | 11,954        | 11,973   |               | 12,106   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b>      | 3,283         | 3,283    | 3,392         | 3,169    |               | 2,561    |
| <b>Production</b>            | 33,340        | 33,638   | 29,273        | 28,775   |               | 32,551   |
| <b>MY Imports</b>            | 20,616        | 20,620   | 22,930        | 22,720   |               | 21,440   |
| <b>Total Supply</b>          | 57,239        | 57,541   | 55,595        | 54,664   |               | 56,552   |
| <b>MY Exports</b>            | 1,344         | 1,343    | 1,070         | 1,185    |               | 1,395    |
| <b>Crush</b>                 | 48,290        | 48,693   | 46,870        | 46,775   |               | 47,985   |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b>   | 1,515         | 1,485    | 1,570         | 1,525    |               | 1,530    |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> | 2,698         | 2,848    | 2,818         | 2,618    |               | 2,748    |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b>      | 52,503        | 53,026   | 51,258        | 50,918   |               | 52,263   |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b>         | 3,392         | 3,169    | 3,267         | 2,561    |               | 2,894    |
| <b>Total Distribution</b>    | 57,239        | 57,538   | 55,595        | 54,664   |               | 56,552   |
| (1000 ha, 1000 MT)           |               |          |               |          |               |          |

Note: Total Oilseeds includes the following: soybean, rapeseed, sunflower, peanut, cottonseed. The crush number of oilseeds is different to the crush number of meals because cottonseed crush is only included in oilseeds.

Source: FAS EU

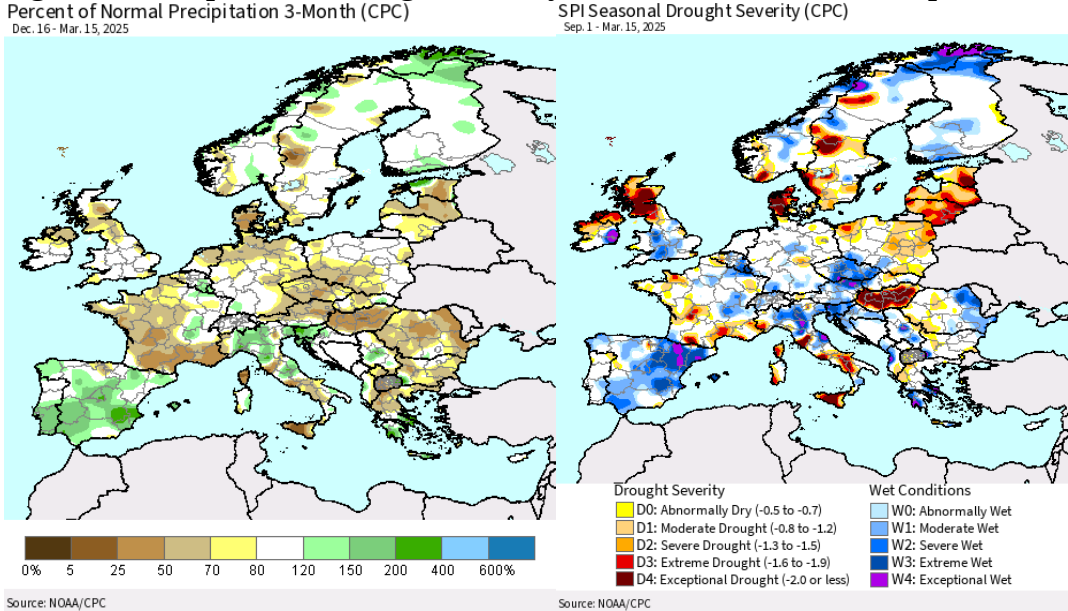
Total European Union (EU) oilseeds area in marketing year (MY) 2025/26 is forecast to rebound from MY 2024/25 but remain below MY2023/24 levels. Post anticipates increased rapeseed area will exceed reductions in sunflower and soybean area resulting in a total increase of 1.1 percent compared to the previous MY. Due to expanded area and anticipated better yields, total production is forecast to increase 13 percent over low MY 2024/25 production levels. Planting conditions for spring crops are expected to be favorable in most EU areas. Planting and growing conditions for rapeseed have been generally favorable. While the 2025 winter has been very dry, particularly in Eastern Europe, in mid-March 2025, long-awaited rainfall eased dry conditions leading to favorable soil moisture. During that same period, southern Spain and Italy faced abnormally heavy rainfall, which recharged soil moisture but resulted in delays of spring oilseed plantings.

Figure 1: EU Oilseeds Production and Area (in 1,000 MT, HA)

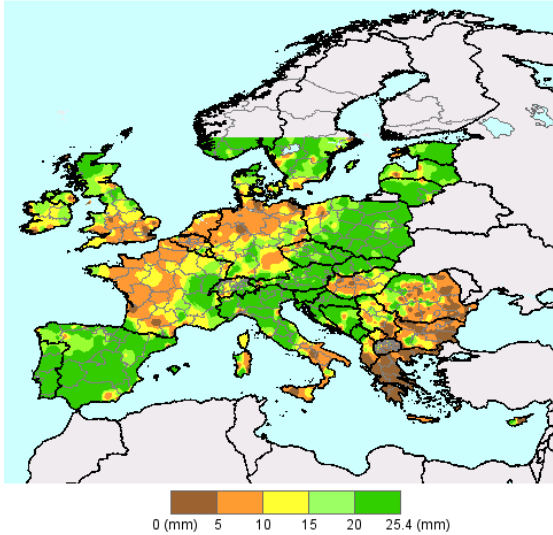


Source: FAS EU

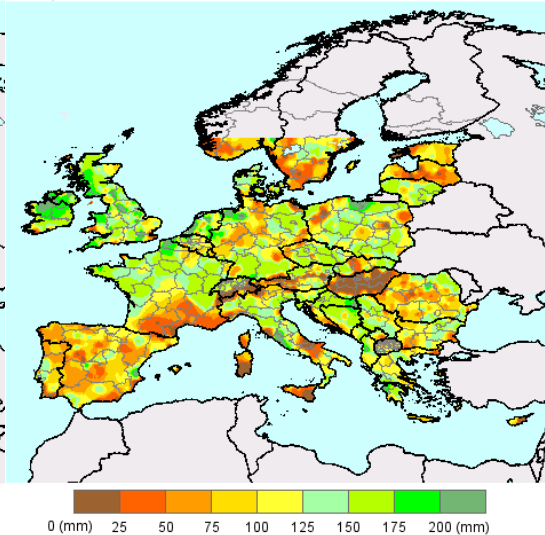
Figure 2: Precipitation, Drought Severity and Soil Moisture in Europe



Surface Soil Moisture (WMO)  
Mar. 15, 2025



Subsurface Soil Moisture (WMO)  
Mar. 15, 2025



Source: World Meteorological Organization

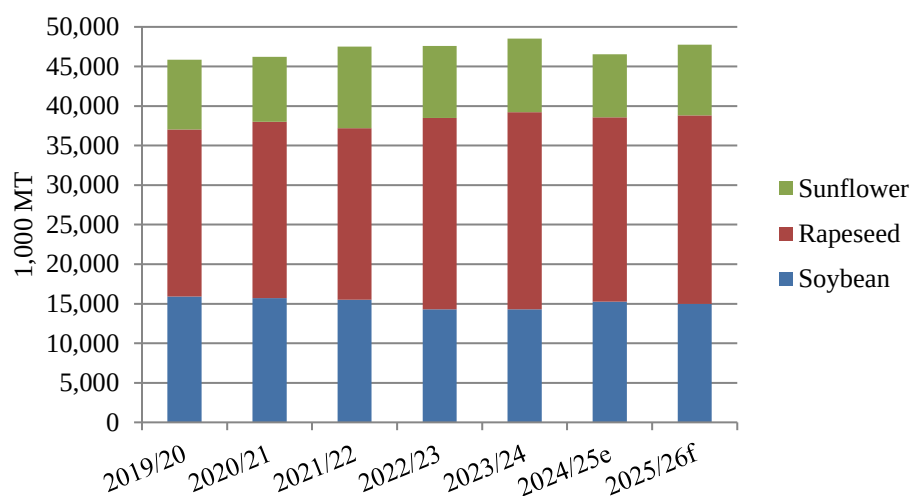
Source: World Meteorological Organization

Source: IPAD/FAS/USDA

As a result of higher MY 2025/26 production, whole oilseed imports are projected to decline year-on-year as local productions meets more EU demand. Total imports are forecast 6 percent lower than in MY 2024/25 with projected lower soybean and rapeseed imports but increased sunflower imports. Imports of soybeans might become more difficult and more expensive due to compliance requirements and costs associated with the EU Deforestation-Free Regulation (EUDR) coming into force at the end of 2025. For more details on EUDR see the Policy section. MY 2025/26 exports are anticipated to recover due to a rebound in domestic supply.

With decreased commodity prices associated with stronger harvests, crush margins are generally anticipated to increase, particularly for sunflower and rapeseed. Overall oilseeds crush is forecast to increase by over 2 percent with higher sunflower and rapeseed crush but slightly reduced soybean crush compared to MY 2024/25.

**Figure 3: EU Oilseeds Crush (in 1,000 MT)**



Source: FAS EU

### Total Oilseeds – Meals

**Table 2: Meals, Total Oilseeds – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Meals, Total Oilseeds        | 2023/24       |          | 2024/25       |          | 2025/26       |          |
|------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
|                              |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| European Union               | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>Crush</b>                 | 48,135        | 48,535   | 46,685        | 46,585   |               | 47,795   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b>      | 1,175         | 1,175    | 1,648         | 2,062    |               | 1,535    |
| <b>Production</b>            | 30,751        | 30,825   | 30,114        | 30,125   |               | 30,700   |
| <b>MY Imports</b>            | 22,157        | 22,272   | 21,545        | 21,630   |               | 21,485   |
| <b>Total Supply</b>          | 54,083        | 54,272   | 53,307        | 53,817   |               | 53,720   |
| <b>MY Exports</b>            | 2,688         | 2,664    | 2,550         | 2,195    |               | 2,117    |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> | 520           | 520      | 520           | 520      |               | 420      |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b>   | 32            | 32       | 32            | 32       |               | 32       |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| <b>Cons.</b>                 | 49,195        | 48,994   | 48,415        | 49,535   |               | 49,430   |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b>      | 49,747        | 49,546   | 48,967        | 50,087   |               | 49,882   |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b>         | 1,648         | 2,062    | 1,790         | 1,535    |               | 1,721    |
| <b>Total Distribution</b>    | 54,083        | 54,272   | 53,307        | 53,817   |               | 53,720   |

(1000 MT)

Note: Total Oilseed Meals includes the following: soybean, rapeseed, sunflower, palm kernel, peanut, fish meal. The crush number of meals differs from the crush number of oilseeds because cottonseed crush is only included in oilseeds.

Source: FAS EU

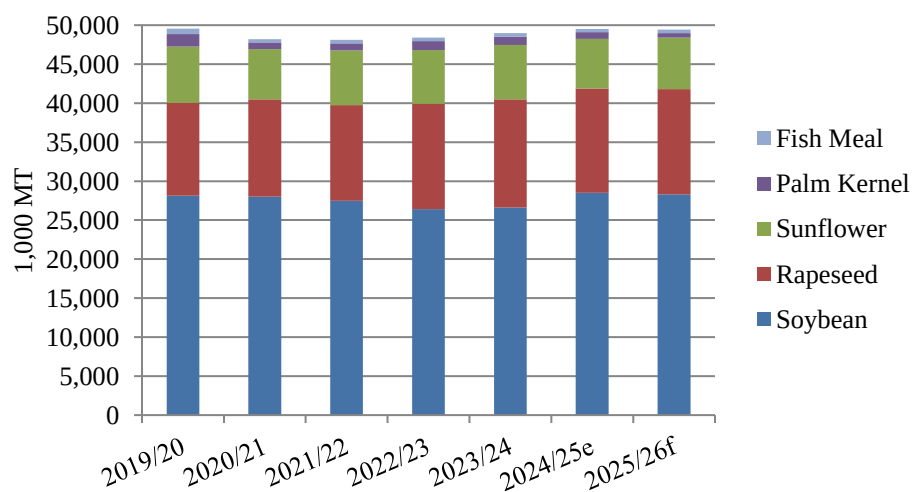
Following increased crush in MY 2025/26, EU oilseed meal production is forecast to rebound from the low current MY but not to the full level of MY 2023/24.

Post estimates oilseeds meal feed use will decline slightly from MY 2024/25 as poultry production increases, dairy feed remains steady, and cattle and swine populations decline. According to local sources, the EU feed sector is likely to use more grains this year due to increased availability and more competitive pricing compared to many oilseed meals. For more details on animals, animal products, and feed demand, please check related reports under the following links and review the [FAS GAIN Database](#)<sup>1</sup> for the most recent updates:

[EU Poultry and Products Semi-Annual 2025](#)  
[EU Livestock and Products Semi-Annual 2025](#)  
[EU Dairy and Products Annual 2024](#)  
[EU Grain and Feed Quarterly, Dec. 2024](#)

Sunflower and rapeseed meal are anticipated to see increased use by the EU feed sector due to lower prices following better harvests. Despite ample global supplies, MY 2025/26 soy meal imports are expected to remain steady due to compliance requirements and costs associated with EUDR. EUDR is anticipated to increase prices for soy and palm suppliers are able to comply with its requirements, while other suppliers who are unable to do so will likely face restricted access to the EU. Consequently, this will likely make soybean meal, and palm kernel meal less attractive in feed ratios.

**Figure 4: EU Oilseed Meals – Feed, Seed, Waste Use (in 1,000 MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

<sup>1</sup> <https://gain.fas.usda.gov/#/>



## Total Oilseeds – Oils

**Table 3: Oils, Total Oilseeds – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Oils, Total Oilseeds         | 2023/24       |          | 2024/25       |          | 2025/26       |          |
|------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
|                              |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| European Union               | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>Crush</b>                 | 48,135        | 48,535   | 46,685        | 46,585   |               | 47,795   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b>      | 2,166         | 2,166    | 2,510         | 2,664    |               | 2,400    |
| <b>Production</b>            | 18,428        | 18,685   | 18,080        | 18,083   |               | 18,553   |
| <b>MY Imports</b>            | 9,331         | 9,342    | 8,675         | 7,895    |               | 7,940    |
| <b>Total Supply</b>          | 29,925        | 30,193   | 29,265        | 28,642   |               | 28,893   |
| <b>MY Exports</b>            | 3,252         | 3,170    | 3,041         | 3,123    |               | 3,199    |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> | 11,100        | 11,150   | 10,880        | 10,055   |               | 10,180   |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b>   | 12,815        | 12,971   | 12,922        | 12,831   |               | 12,912   |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> | 248           | 238      | 218           | 233      |               | 237      |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b>      | 24,163        | 24,359   | 24,020        | 23,119   |               | 23,329   |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b>         | 2,510         | 2,664    | 2,204         | 2,400    |               | 2,365    |
| <b>Total Distribution</b>    | 29,925        | 30,193   | 29,265        | 28,642   |               | 28,893   |

(1000 MT)

Note: Total Oilseed Oils includes the following: soybean, rapeseed, sunflower, palm kernel, palm oil, peanut, coconut, and olive oil. The crush number of oils is different to the crush number of oilseeds because cottonseed crush is only included in oilseeds.

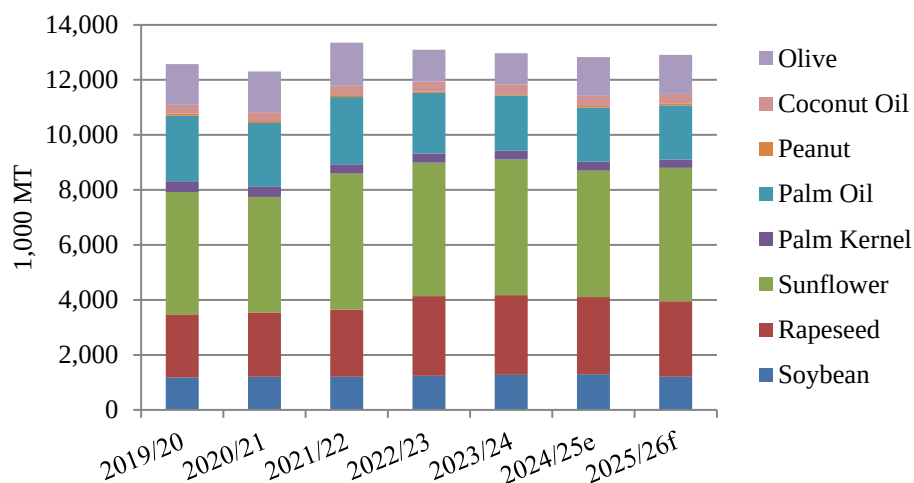
Source: FAS EU

Post anticipates higher crush in 2025/26 will lead to a corresponding increase in oilseed oil/vegetable oil production. MY 2025/26 oil production is anticipated to increase 2.6 percent over the current MY. The increase is mainly driven by higher sunflower and rapeseed oil production. Higher production is expected to reduce vegetable oil prices, increasing food use. EU consumers are likely to continue to turn to oils with perceived health benefits, such as sunflower oil, and away from oils with perceived negative health or environmental impacts like palm oil. Industrial use is set to slightly increase, however biofuel production from some oils, such as palm oil, is anticipated to decline as many EU member states (MS) continue to phase out palm oil use for their energy needs due to concerns about its environmental sustainability. Vegetable oil use for biofuel production also faces increasing competition from non-crop or waste-based feed stock such as used cooking oil (UCO).

For further information on biofuels production, please check the report under the following link:

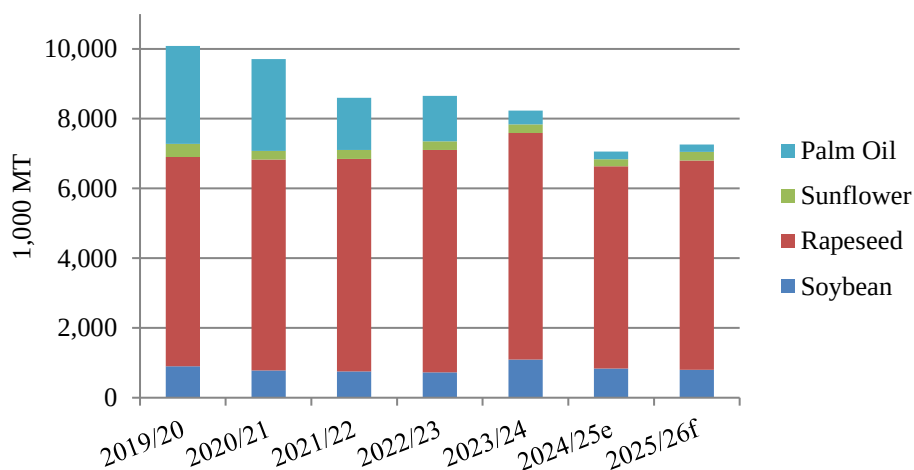
[EU Biofuels Annual 2024](#)

**Figure 3: EU Oilseed Oils, Food Use (in 1,000 MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast  
Source: FAS EU

**Figure 4: EU Oilseed Oils, Biofuels Use (in 1,000 MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast  
Source: FAS EU

## Policy

In February 2022, Russian forces invaded Ukraine, which continues to put pressure on global food security as both countries are major exporters of feed and oilseeds products. The EU adopted several measures to enhance global food security and to mitigate the impact of the war for EU farmers given rising commodity and inputs prices.

In December 2024, the European institutions decided to postpone the entry into force of the EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR), which regulates the entry of several products including soybean products and palm oil into the Union. The Regulation will now enter into application on December 30, 2025.

On March 12, 2025, the United States imposed tariffs of up to 25% on imports of steel, aluminum, and certain products containing steel and aluminum from the European Union. The European Union is assessing imposing retaliatory tariffs to a [list of U.S. products](#)<sup>2</sup> including soybeans, rapeseeds, fish oil, groundnut oil, palm oil, sunflower oil and margarine. Please note that the list published by the European Commission is only preliminary and not yet final nor adopted. A final decision is expected by mid-April 2025.

For more information see the Policy section below.

## 2. Soybean Complex

### Soybean Seed

**Table 4: Oilseed, Soybean – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Oilseed, Soybean<br>Market Year Begins                                      | 2023/2024        |             | 2024/2025        |             | 2025/2026        |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|
|                                                                             | Oct 2023         |             | Oct 2024         |             | Oct 2025         |             |
| European Union                                                              | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post |
| Area Planted (1000 HA)                                                      | 1200             | 0           | 1200             | 0           |                  | 0           |
| Area Harvested (1000 HA)                                                    | 1027             | 1013        | 1085             | 1128        |                  | 1080        |
| Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)                                                  | 1084             | 1084        | 1119             | 886         |                  | 1146        |
| Production (1000 MT)                                                        | 2947             | 2794        | 2850             | 2950        |                  | 2950        |
| MY Imports (1000 MT)                                                        | 13461            | 13461       | 14600            | 14600       |                  | 14000       |
| Total Supply (1000 MT)                                                      | 17492            | 17339       | 18569            | 18436       |                  | 18096       |
| MY Exports (1000 MT)                                                        | 253              | 253         | 300              | 290         |                  | 260         |
| Crush (1000 MT)                                                             | 14500            | 14300       | 15200            | 15250       |                  | 15000       |
| Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                               | 220              | 200         | 220              | 200         |                  | 200         |
| Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                             | 1400             | 1700        | 1550             | 1550        |                  | 1550        |
| Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                                  | 16120            | 16200       | 16970            | 17000       |                  | 16750       |
| Ending Stocks (1000 MT)                                                     | 1119             | 886         | 1299             | 1146        |                  | 1086        |
| Total Distribution (1000 MT)                                                | 17492            | 17339       | 18569            | 18436       |                  | 18096       |
| Yield (MT/HA)                                                               | 2.8695           | 2.7581      | 2.6267           | 2.6152      |                  | 2.7315      |
| (1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)                                               |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |

<sup>2</sup> <https://circabc.europa.eu/ui/group/e9d50ad8-e41f-4379-839a-fdfe08f0aa96/library/9f483239-477f-4f14-8e2a-a09e1edb1f3d/details?download=true>

Source: FAS EU

### **MY 2025/26**

MY 2025/26 soybean area harvested is forecast to decline by about 4 percent year-on-year as many farmers are anticipated to switch from soy to rapeseed and wheat due to higher prices for these commodities resulting from low harvests in MY 2024/25. Overall soybean area remains above MY 2023/24 levels but is still much smaller than rapeseed and sunflower area. Reductions in soybean area are reported for Italy, Romania, Hungary, and Croatia. France, Austria and to a lesser extent Slovakia, and Poland report area increases; however, these increases are not enough to offset reductions elsewhere. MY 2025/26 production is forecast to remain unchanged year-on-year as higher yields offset area reductions, assuming normal growing conditions.

Italy, France, Romania, Austria, Croatia, and Hungary are the largest producers of soybeans within the EU. Major drivers for soybean planting include favorable margins for farmers; lower input usage compared to other crops, as soybeans are nitrogen fixing and less dependent on fertilizers; and high domestic demand for “non-GMO” or non-GE (“genetically modified organisms” or non-genetically engineered) soybeans for feed and food use. Soybeans also remain the crop of choice for planting under the EU’s nitrogen fixing crops subsidy program which incentivizes higher planted area, however, participation in this program varies.

Currently, planting conditions appear to be generally favorable as very dry winter conditions - particularly in Eastern Europe - have shifted to rainfall starting in mid-March which has improved soil moisture. In some areas, like southern Spain and Italy, heavy rainfalls in mid-March resulted in delayed spring oilseed plantings which might have a negative impact on yields.

Imports in MY 2025/26 are forecast to decline by about 4 percent, as crush demand for soybeans will be lower due to higher domestic production of rapeseed and sunflower. As of the beginning of 2026, soybean imports might become more difficult and more expensive due to compliance requirements by the EUDR (see policy section). The EU is the world’s second-largest importer of soybeans and soybean products. The top four soybean seed suppliers to the EU are Brazil, the United States, Ukraine, and Canada. The EU’s leading importers are the Netherlands, Spain, Germany, and Italy. These four countries are also the main crushers producing soybean oil and soybean meal.

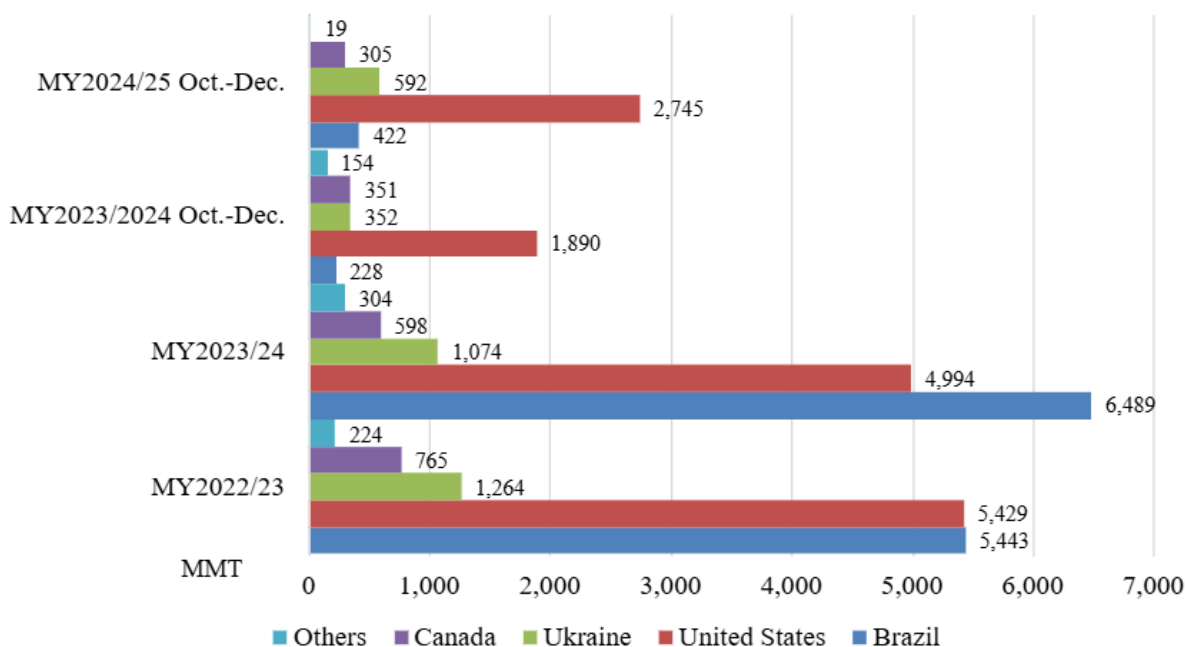
MY 2025/26 crush is anticipated to decline slightly due to higher supplies of rapeseed and sunflower seeds. Crush margins for soybeans may face competition from rapeseed and are projected to be less attractive than in the current season. While crush is expected to decline, the reduction will likely be limited as soybeans remain an important protein source for the feed sector which cannot be easily replaced by other sources, particularly for the growing EU poultry sector. Among the major EU crushers, Germany, Spain and the Netherlands, and Romania expect stable crush while marginal decreases are projected for Italy, Portugal, France, and Greece.

## MY 2024/25

Driven by favorable commodity prices, EU soybean area in MY 2024/25 reached an all-time high. Weather conditions in MY 2024/25 were characterized by drought during the summer and exceptionally wet conditions in September in major producing Member States. This led to lower average yields, however soybean production was not as severely affected as sunflower and rapeseed due to its relative tolerance for adverse weather. Due to increased area, EU soybean production reached almost three MMT, an increase of nearly 6 percent compared to the previous MY.

Imports of soybean seeds are expected to rise 8 percent to compensate for low rapeseed and sunflower production and availability. Abundant and price-competitive foreign supplies, along with favorable domestic demand and attractive crush margins have already triggered an increase in imports. In the first quarter of MY 2024/25 (October-December 2024), the EU imported 37 percent more soybean seeds (4.1 MMT) compared to the first quarter of MY 2023/24. Leading suppliers were the United States (67 percent market share), Ukraine (15 percent), Brazil (10 percent), and Canada (source: TDM). Imports from the United States (2.74 MMT) for the first quarter were the highest since MY 2018/2019 and 45 percent more than a year ago. This upward trend continued although at a slower pace in early 2025 with a reported 7 percent increase year-on-year to 9.8 MMT as of the last week of March (source: [EU Customs](#), covering the period July 1 2024 to March 23, 2025 ). The largest EU importers were Spain, the Netherlands, Germany and Italy. The United States strengthened its leading position as a supplier with 53 percent market share (5.2 MMT), followed by Brazil (30 percent) and Ukraine (12 percent).

**Figure 5: EU Soybean Imports (in thousand MT)**

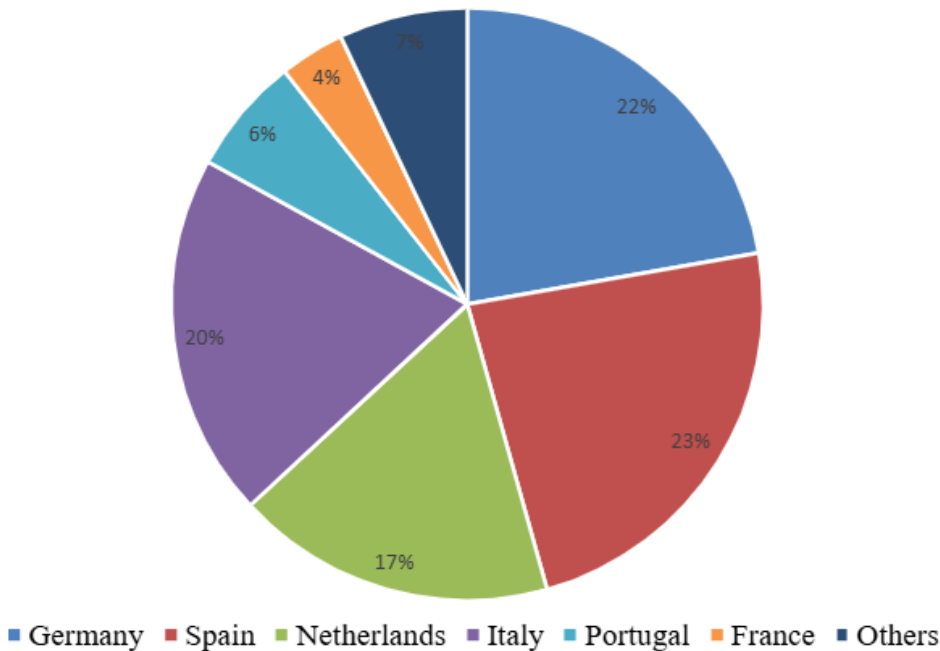


Source: TDM

Soybean crush is expected to increase 7 percent year-on-year due to competitive crush margins for soybeans resulting from lower sunflower seed and rapeseed supply and higher sunflower and rapeseed prices. According to local sources, soybean crush margins are currently higher than those for rapeseed

and sunflower and several multi-seed crushers switched soybeans in the first half of MY 2024/25. According to industry reports (source: [FEDOIL](#)), from October 2024 to February 2025, EU soybean crush increased 18 percent compared to the corresponding period in the previous MY. Currently, Germany, the Netherlands, Portugal, France, Romania, Hungary and Greece expect to have higher crush in the current season while Spain expects a decline.

**Figure 8:** EU Soybean Crushers MY2023/24



Source: FAS EU

Due to uncertainties related to the planned December 2025 implementation of EUDR, ending stocks are expected to increase as importers bring in soybeans before possible restrictions and compliance costs take effect.

## Soybean Meal

**Table 5: Soybean meal – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Meal, Soybean                                                               | 2023/2024     |          | 2024/2025     |          | 2025/2026     |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
| Market Year Begins                                                          | Oct 2023      |          | Oct 2024      |          | Oct 2025      |          |
| European Union                                                              | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 14500         | 14300    | 15200         | 15250    |               | 15000    |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0.79          | 0.7832   | 0.79          | 0.7934   |               | 0.7867   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 410           | 410      | 808           | 854      |               | 832      |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 11455         | 11200    | 12008         | 12100    |               | 11800    |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 16538         | 16538    | 17600         | 17000    |               | 17050    |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 28403         | 28148    | 30416         | 29954    |               | 29682    |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 653           | 652      | 900           | 580      |               | 500      |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 10            | 10       | 10            | 10       |               | 10       |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 32            | 32       | 32            | 32       |               | 32       |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 26900         | 26600    | 28250         | 28500    |               | 28300    |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 26942         | 26642    | 28292         | 28542    |               | 28342    |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 808           | 854      | 1224          | 832      |               | 840      |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 28403         | 28148    | 30416         | 29954    |               | 29682    |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |               |          |               |          |               |          |

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2025/26

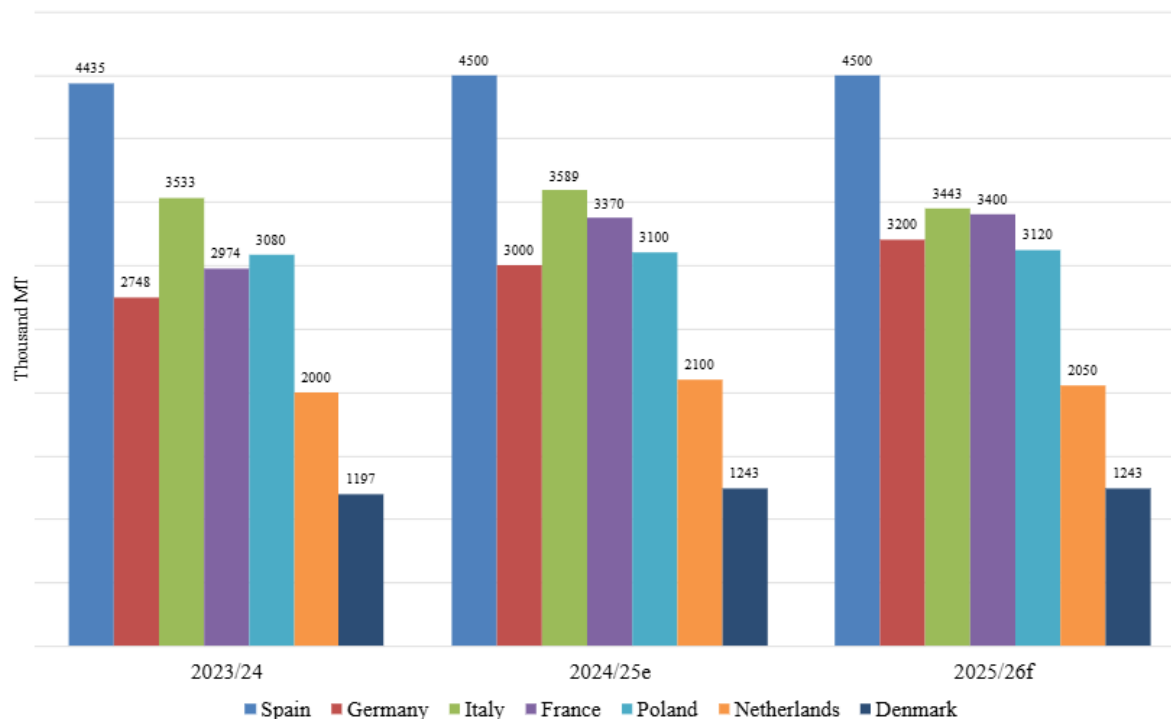
In MY 2025/26, soybean meal production is forecast to decline by about 3 percent to 11.8 MMT, due to lower crush volumes. Nevertheless, production of soybean meal will still represent the largest share of EU oilseed meal production. Germany, the Netherlands, Spain and Italy are expected to remain the leading producers with anticipated stable crush levels while Italy, France, Portugal, Greece, Hungary and Belgium are expected to see small reductions. Romania expects crush growth.

MY 2025/26 imports are expected to remain largely unchanged year-on-year. While meal is likely to be more expensive due to compliance costs associated with EUDR, demand for soy meal will be boosted by protein needs in the animal feed sector, particularly the poultry sector which is expected to continue to grow. Additionally, meal imports will be supported by increased demand for lysine following the imposition of anti-dumping duties on Chinese lysine imports in January 2025. The EU current supplies 60 percent of its Lysine demand through imports from China. Lysine is an essential amino acid important for feed formulation. Local sources anticipate EU feed millers will turn to soy meal as an alternative as it is naturally rich in lysine.

Exports of soybean meal are projected to decrease by 14 percent compared to MY 2024/25, due to lower crushing, minor stockpiling associated with EUDR, and increased demand for lysine within the EU.

Soybean meal is the most important component of animal feed in the EU, particularly for poultry and swine, due to its high protein content, nutritional benefits and price competitiveness. Feed producers favor soybean meal for optimizing formulations and maintaining cost efficiency. In MY 2025/26, consumption is forecast at 28.3 MMT, largely unchanged from MY 2024/25. The primary EU consumers of soybean meal will remain Spain, Germany, Italy, France, Poland, the Netherlands, and Denmark. Increasing soybean meal feed demand is reported for Germany, France, and Poland, and stable demand for Spain. Italy and the Netherlands anticipate declining soybean meal feed use.

**Figure 9: Main EU Soybean Meal Consumers (in thousand MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2024/25

Industry reports indicate that EU crushers and traders made efforts to prepare for the initial December 2024 implementation of EUDR by generating higher beginning stocks, with beginning stocks twice as high as the year before.

In line with estimated higher crush, MY 2024/25 soybean meal production is expected to increase by 8 percent compared to MY 2023/24. In addition, the EU is forecast to import 3 percent more soybean meal reaching a record high of 17 MMT, driven by favorable demand due to decreased supplies of sunflower and rapeseed meals. These imports were facilitated by available and affordable foreign supplies of meal from traditional trading partners, including Brazil and Argentina.



In the first quarter of MY 2024/25, EU imports surged sharply upwards to 5.95 MMT, 60 percent higher than in the corresponding period in the previous season. Brazil was a leading supplier, followed by Argentina, India and Ukraine. This trend was preserved and as of the last week of March, EU imports of soybean meal were 27 percent more than a year ago to 13.6 MMT (source: [EU Customs](#), covering the EU MY year to date (July 2024 to March 2025)). Brazil was leading with 49 percent market share (6.7 MMT), followed by Argentina (38 percent), and Ukraine (about 5 percent).

The main suppliers of soybean meal to the EU have remained consistent over the past five years, with Brazil and Argentina alternating between first and second place, followed by the U.S., Ukraine, and Paraguay. As of March 2025, the largest importers in the EU for MY 2024/25 are Poland, Spain, the Netherlands, France, Italy, and Germany.

Feed use is anticipated to grow by 7 percent, offsetting a deficit in rapeseed and sunflower meal supply. The growing EU poultry industry is the largest consumer, which has been supported by strong internal demand for poultry meat, growing exports, and a reduction in HPAI outbreaks (for more see the [Poultry and Products Semi-Annual 2025 report](#)). Conversely, consumption by the beef and pork sectors is estimated to decline (see the [EU Livestock Semi-Annual 2025 report](#)), due to livestock industry challenges related to high input costs, regulatory pressures, reduced exports to China, and potential anti-dumping measures. Stable-to-higher soybean meal use is reported by a majority of EU Member States such as Spain, Germany, the Netherlands, Italy, France, Poland, Denmark, Portugal, Romania, Greece, Ireland, and Hungary. Belgium, Lithuania and Slovenia report marginal declines.

Soybean meal exports are projected to decline by 11 percent to ensure sufficient ending stocks in preparation of EUDR implementation in December 2025. At the end of March, exports were at 350,000 MT (source: [EU Customs](#), covering the EU MY, July 2024 to March 2025) with main destinations including the United Kingdom (42 percent), Switzerland (20 percent) and Türkiye (nine percent). Major EU exporters include the Netherlands, Germany and Greece.

## Soybean Oil

**Table 6: Oil, Soybean – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Oil, Soybean                                                                | 2023/2024     |          | 2024/2025     |          | 2025/2026     |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
| Market Year Begins                                                          | Oct 2023      |          | Oct 2024      |          | Oct 2025      |          |
| European Union                                                              | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 14500         | 14300    | 15200         | 15250    |               | 15000    |
| <b>Extr. Rate,</b><br><b>999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                             | 0.19          | 0.1888   | 0.19          | 0.1836   |               | 0.184    |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 601           | 601      | 655           | 450      |               | 460      |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 2755          | 2700     | 2888          | 2800     |               | 2760     |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 591           | 591      | 650           | 530      |               | 480      |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 3947          | 3892     | 4193          | 3780     |               | 3700     |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 662           | 662      | 950           | 730      |               | 730      |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 1150          | 1460     | 1200          | 1235     |               | 1220     |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 1425          | 1270     | 1400          | 1300     |               | 1200     |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 55            | 50       | 55            | 55       |               | 55       |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 2630          | 2780     | 2655          | 2590     |               | 2475     |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 655           | 450      | 588           | 460      |               | 495      |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 3947          | 3892     | 4193          | 3780     |               | 3700     |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |               |          |               |          |               |          |

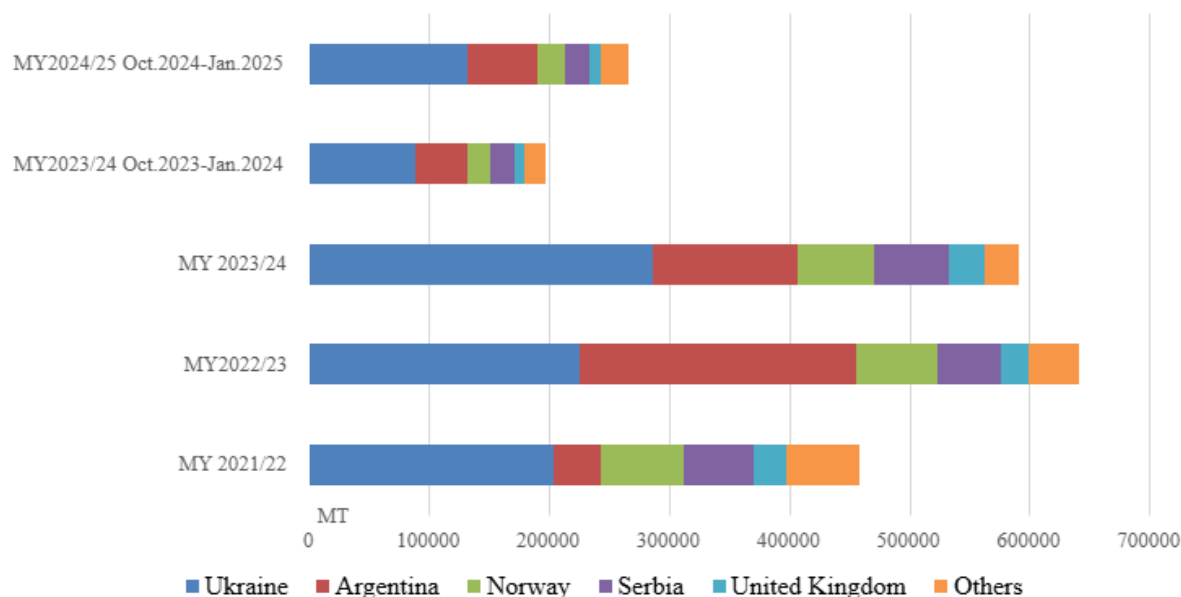
Source: FAS EU

### MY 2025/26

Production of soybean oil is projected to decline by roughly 3 percent, following lower forecasted crush.

Imports of soybean oil are projected to decline by about 10 percent, largely due to changes in U.S. biofuel policy. Prior to January 1, 2025, the EU imported a significant amount of soy oil for processing into biodiesel which was then exported to the United States. This biodiesel benefitted from U.S. blender tax credits. However, under the U.S. Inflation Reduction Act, these tax credits were shifted from blenders to U.S. biodiesel producers, reducing returns on imported EU biodiesel. This shift in policy reduces soy oil import demand for processing and export. Local sources report that soy-based biodiesel exports to the United States largely halted over 2024 in advance of the January 1, 2025 implementation of the Inflation Reduction Act measure.

**Figure 10: EU Soybean Oil Main Suppliers (in MT)**



Source: TDM

The use of soybean oil as a feedstock for biodiesel production is part of a broader mix that includes other vegetable oils, animal fats, and used cooking oil (UCO). The feedstock mix for biodiesel production in the EU has been evolving, with a potential shift away from soybean oil towards rapeseed oil and other feedstocks, a trend that will be reinforced as soy-oil likely becomes more expensive due to EUDR compliance costs. In addition, under the EU Renewable Energy Directive (RED II – see policy section) credit for using crop-based biofuels to achieve renewable energy targets, including those derived from soybean oil, is capped at 7 percent of total use with the option for Member States to set a lower limit.

Soy oil food consumption is expected to decline by 8 percent compared to MY 2024/2025, due to greater availability of alternative oils such as rapeseed, sunflower, and olive oil. Exports are forecast to remain flat.

### MY 2024/25

Soybean oil production is estimated to increase by almost 4 percent to 2.8 MMT, in line with higher crushing levels. Soybean oil contributes significantly to the domestic vegetable oil market, both for food and for industrial use.

Soybean oil use for biodiesel production remained strong until the end of 2024 when U.S. tax incentives were changed based on the Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) and the blending tax credit was replaced by a production tax credit, as discussed above. Local sources in Spain and the Netherlands reported an end to SME exports to the United States associated with IRA tax credits at the end of 2024.

MY 2024/25 soy oil imports are forecast to decline 10 percent compared to MY 2023/24. While imports surged by 41 percent during the first quarter of MY 2024/25 (October to December 2024), they have since declined 59 percent as of the last week of March (per the EU MY, from July 2024 to March 2025),

largely due to lower demand for oil for soy-based biodiesel following the implementation of the IRA. The EU's main suppliers over this time period included Ukraine and Norway with 28 percent share each, followed by Serbia with 22 percent and the United Kingdom (17 percent). Greece, Denmark and Bulgaria were the main importing countries.

Food use of soybean oil is estimated to increase by two percent due to higher crush resulting from sunflower and rapeseed shortfalls.

Exports of soybean oil are projected to grow by 10 percent compared to MY 2023/24, reflecting lower EU industrial use and higher demand in foreign markets. In the first quarter of MY 2024/25, exports doubled (210,000 MT) compared to the first quarter of the previous season. The main destinations were Morocco, the United Kingdom and Algeria (source: TDM). The trend has moderated and as of the last week of March exports were 16 percent higher than a year ago (517,000 MT, covering July 2024 to March 2025). Spain and the Netherlands were the leading exporters, followed distantly by France, Italy and Portugal. Morocco was the main export market (52 percent), followed by the United Kingdom (19 percent) and Algeria (five percent). Higher demand for domestic biofuels production is expected to preempt exports of soybean oil from expanding.

### **3. Rapeseed Complex**

In MY 2023/24 the EU was the global leading producer of rapeseed, even before Canada and China. Due to lower planted acreage as well as unfavorable weather conditions in the EU for MY 2024/25, Canada was able to surpass the EU as the number one producer of rapeseed. The EU produced 20 percent of global rapeseed supply, following only Canada at 22 percent of global supply in MY 2024/25. Although the EU is a large producer of rapeseed, it is still dependent on imports to fully utilize its crushing capacities.

Rapeseed production in the EU is driven mainly by the demand for rapeseed oil. Most rapeseed oil is employed for the production of biodiesel, which is incentivized through consumption mandates set by the EU Renewable Energy Directive (RED). Rapeseed meal is used for feed mainly in dairy cattle and swine production. Due to EUDR, importing soy and products thereof could become increasingly complex and costly starting on December 30, 2025. As previously explained in the soybean section, this could decrease imports of soybeans and products thereof. This reduction in imports could lead to more room on the EU market for rapeseed oil and meal as alternatives, as these commodities are not affected by EUDR.

The Russia-Ukraine War has significantly impacted the global rapeseed market. The war has had an effect on rapeseed trade as well as production costs. Despite the ongoing war, Ukraine became the number one exporter of rapeseed to the EU in MY 2023/24, even surpassing Australia. Exports of rapeseed from Ukraine to the EU have increased by almost 50 percent between July and December 2024 in comparison to the same time period in 2023. This suggests that Ukraine may remain a large exporter to the EU. It is currently unclear how the war will affect global rapeseed production and trade in the future.

## Rapeseed – OILSEED

**Table 7: Oilseed, Rapeseed – Production, Supply and Distribution**

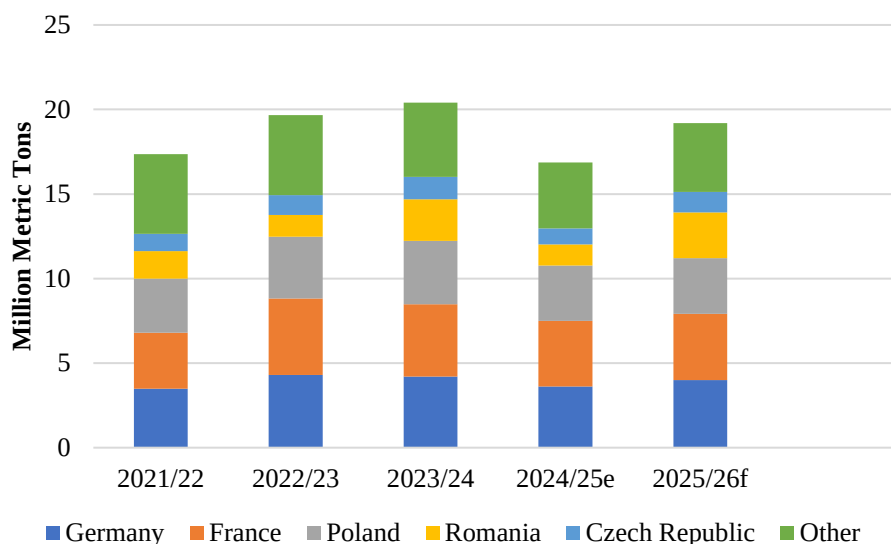
| Oilseed, Rapeseed<br>Market Year Begins                                     | 2023/2024        |          | 2024/2025        |          | 2025/2026        |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|
|                                                                             | Oct 2023         |          | Oct 2024         |          | Oct 2025         |          |
|                                                                             | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post |
| <b>European Union</b>                                                       |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| <b>Area Planted</b> (1000 HA)                                               | 6400             | 0        | 6500             | 0        |                  | 0        |
| <b>Area Harvested</b> (1000 HA)                                             | 6210             | 6263     | 5690             | 5700     |                  | 5960     |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 1686             | 1686     | 1493             | 1612     |                  | 932      |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 19934            | 20403    | 17240            | 16870    |                  | 19200    |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 5457             | 5457     | 7000             | 6500     |                  | 5800     |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 27077            | 27546    | 25733            | 24982    |                  | 25932    |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 534              | 534      | 300              | 350      |                  | 470      |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 24400            | 24900    | 23450            | 23300    |                  | 23800    |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 0                | 0        | 0                | 0        |                  | 0        |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 650              | 500      | 600              | 400      |                  | 530      |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 25050            | 25400    | 24050            | 23700    |                  | 24330    |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 1493             | 1612     | 1383             | 932      |                  | 1132     |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 27077            | 27546    | 25733            | 24982    |                  | 25932    |
| <b>Yield</b> (MT/HA)                                                        | 3.21             | 3.2577   | 3.0299           | 2.9596   |                  | 3.2215   |
| (1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)                                               |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2025/26

In MY 2025/26, production is expected to recover from low levels seen in MY 2024/25. Due to low production in MY 2024/25, rapeseed prices have increased, creating an incentive for producers to plant more area with rapeseed. Yields are expected to improve due to better anticipated growing conditions. Production is expected to increase in all major EU rapeseed producing countries including Germany, France, Romania, the Czech Republic, and Poland for MY 2025/26 in comparison to the previous marketing year.

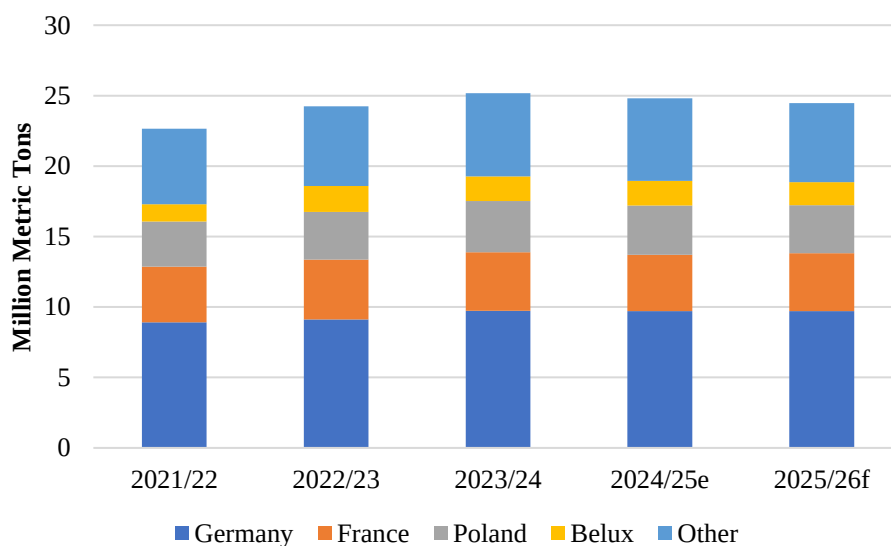
**Figure 11: EU Rapeseed Production (in million MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast  
Source: FAS EU

Beginning stocks in MY 2025/26 are forecast to be comparatively low due to estimated low production in MY 2024/25. Rapeseed stocks are forecast to be replenished (up 22 percent) over the course of MY 2025/26 due to better production.

**Figure 12: Main EU Rapeseed Crushers**

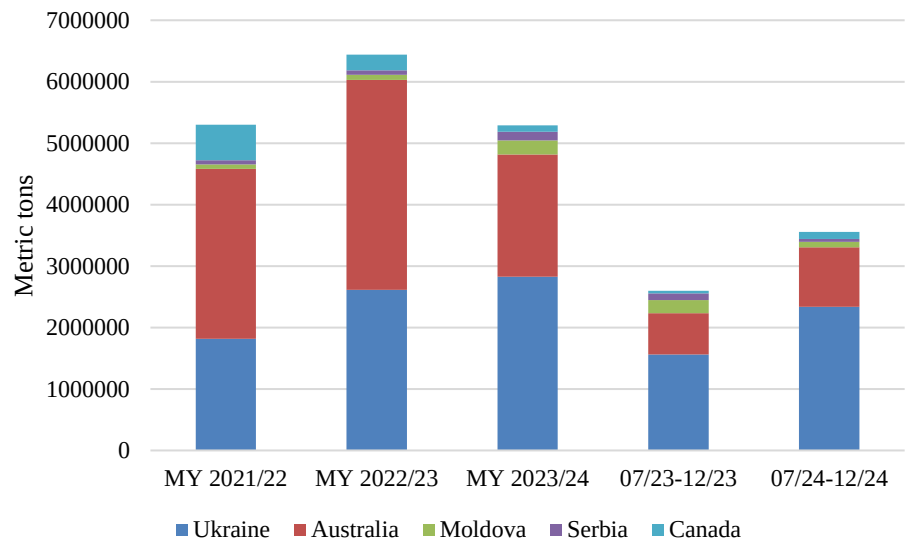


e = estimate, f = forecast  
Source: FAS EU

MY 2025/26 crush is anticipated to increase due to higher rapeseed production and better crush margins as rapeseed prices decline in line with a better expected harvest. The EU is expected to stay below its maximum crushing capacity, although due to data constraints it is difficult to determine maximum

crushing capacity. Crushing in Poland is forecast to remain at a lower level than usual as there will most likely not be enough rapeseed available to fully utilize their crushing capacity in MY 2025/26. Bulgarian crushers that switched to crushing rapeseed from sunflower seed in MY 2024/25 due to higher rapeseed crushing margins are forecast to switch back to sunflower in MY 2025/26. Germany and France are predicted to continue crushing rapeseed at similar levels as in MY 2024/25. In both of these countries, facilities usually do not switch between oilseeds. The Czech Republic, after crushing less in MY 2024/25, is forecast to recover in 2025/26. In the Czech Republic, crushers usually do not switch between oilseeds due to the technological limitations.

**Figure 13: Main Rapeseed Exporters to the EU (in MT)**



Source: TDM

Imports are forecast to decrease due to increased domestic production. As previously mentioned, the EU mainly imports rapeseed from Ukraine. However, rapeseed area in Ukraine is anticipated to decrease for MY 2025/26, which may reduce exportable supplies to the EU. The EU has also historically supplied rapeseed from Australia and Canada, which may increase their exports to the EU if there is a shortfall from Ukraine. EU MY 2024/25 exports are forecast to increase driven by higher overall production.

**MY 2024/25**

MY 2024/25 area harvested is expected to decrease significantly (by about 9 percent) year-on-year due to several factors including high fertilizer prices and lower prices for rapeseed. Unfavorable weather conditions in many Member States, including large rapeseed producers, depressed yields, further decreasing production. The drop in production is anticipated to lower exports due to decreased exportable supplies and increase imports as crushers turn to foreign suppliers to meet domestic demand. The EU mostly imports from Ukraine, where the prices are generally lower than in the EU. Other top exporting countries include Australia and Canada. From July to December 2024, imports from Canada have increased 179 percent compared to the same timeframe in 2023.

In addition to turning to foreign suppliers for seed, crushers are also anticipated to reduce available stocks to meet oil and meal demand. MY 2024/25 ending stocks are estimated to decline 42 percent year

on year. Overall crushing is expected to drop 6 percent due to lower available supplies, with crushers in most EU Member States decreasing rapeseed crush. An exception is Bulgaria where rapeseed crushing increased 120 percent year-on-year as some crushers switched from sunflower to rapeseed due to advantageous crush margins.

## **RAPSEED – MEAL**

**Table 8: Meal, Rapeseed – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| <b>Meal, Rapeseed<br/>Market Year Begins</b>                                | <b>2023/2024</b>         |                 | <b>2024/2025</b>         |                 | <b>2025/2026</b>         |                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|
|                                                                             | <b>Oct 2023</b>          |                 | <b>Oct 2024</b>          |                 | <b>Oct 2025</b>          |                 |
|                                                                             | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> |
| <b>European Union</b>                                                       |                          |                 |                          |                 |                          |                 |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 24400                    | 24900           | 23450                    | 23300           |                          | 23800           |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0.57                     | 0.5731          | 0.57                     | 0.5708          |                          | 0.5735          |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 431                      | 431             | 393                      | 755             |                          | 405             |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 13908                    | 14270           | 13367                    | 13300           |                          | 13650           |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 823                      | 823             | 650                      | 590             |                          | 750             |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 15162                    | 15524           | 14410                    | 14645           |                          | 14805           |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 869                      | 869             | 650                      | 840             |                          | 750             |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 13900                    | 13900           | 13200                    | 13400           |                          | 13500           |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 13900                    | 13900           | 13200                    | 13400           |                          | 13500           |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 393                      | 755             | 560                      | 405             |                          | 555             |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 15162                    | 15524           | 14410                    | 14645           |                          | 14805           |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |                          |                 |                          |                 |                          |                 |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                          |                 |                          |                 |                          |                 |

Source: FAS EU

### **MY 2025/26**

MY 2025/26 rapeseed meal production is forecast to recover from MY 2024/25 levels as a better rapeseed harvest increases available seed for crushing and improves rapeseed crushing margins. MY 2025/26 imports are anticipated to increase by roughly 27 percent in part as an affordable substitute for soy meal as soy meal faces increased compliance costs associated with the implementation of EUDR on December 30, 2025. While rapeseed meal can be used to substitute soy meal in the feed sector to a degree, it is not possible to completely substitute soybean meal with rapeseed meal due to their different properties in animal feed. For more information, please see the soybean and policy sections. Post anticipates exports will decline slightly due to high domestic demand for rapeseed meal as an alternative to soy meal in the feed sector.

In general, the EU does not produce a sufficient amount of protein crops to satisfy demand for animal feed and rapeseed meal is used almost exclusively in feed formulation. Germany is by far the Member State that utilizes the largest amount of rapeseed meal for feed.

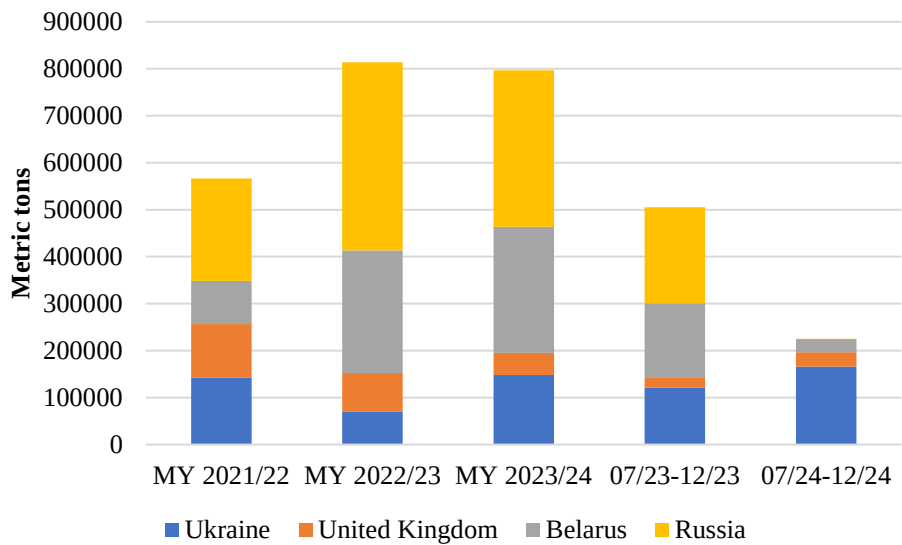


MY 2024/25

MY 2024/25 production is estimated to decline by about 7 percent as a poor rapeseed harvest reduces rapeseed availability and crushing margins decline due to higher rapeseed prices. While spot market prices decreased even below \$ 400 in 2023, prices significantly increased in 2024 and 2025, even breaking the \$500 mark at times According to local sources, reductions in crushing are anticipated throughout the EU and are not concentrated in specific Member States. Post estimates stocks will decline 46 percent reflecting tight rapeseed supplies. Exports are also anticipated to decline due to low production.

Imports are also anticipated to decrease due lower available supplies. EU import flows have changed following the imposition of duties on Russian and Belarussian rapeseed meal in July 2024. Historically Russia and Belarus have been the two largest suppliers of rapeseed meal to the EU for many years (Figure 14). Since the imposition of duties on these countries, EU crushers have turned to Ukrainian and UK rapeseed meal as a partial alternative. Rapeseed meal imports from Ukraine and the UK are up by 37 and 33 percent respectively over the period July through December 2024 year-on-year. According to local sources, this could be an opportunity for Canadian imports, as Canadian rapeseed exporters find alternative markets following the imposition of Chinese tariffs on March 20, 2025. Imports may face headwinds due to GE-content. Thus, Canadian rapeseed imports may be particularly attractive in Member States that do not heavily utilize GE-free feed for dairy production. Currently Germany, Austria, and Bulgaria largely use GE-free animal feed in their dairy sector while Poland has deferred a GE feed ban until 2030.

Figure 14: Main Rapeseed Meal Exporters to the EU (in MT)



Source: TDM

## RAPESEED – OIL

**Table 9: Oil, Rapeseed – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Oil, Rapeseed<br>Market Year Begins                                         | 2023/2024        |          | 2024/2025        |          | 2025/2026        |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|
|                                                                             | Oct 2023         |          | Oct 2024         |          | Oct 2025         |          |
|                                                                             | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post |
| <b>European Union</b>                                                       |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 24400            | 24900    | 23450            | 23300    |                  | 23800    |
| <b>Extr. Rate,</b><br><b>999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                             | 0.42             | 0.4217   | 0.42             | 0.4202   |                  | 0.4202   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 291              | 291      | 305              | 363      |                  | 313      |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 10248            | 10500    | 9849             | 9790     |                  | 10000    |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 463              | 463      | 450              | 300      |                  | 350      |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 11002            | 11254    | 10604            | 10453    |                  | 10663    |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 747              | 746      | 600              | 750      |                  | 750      |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 7050             | 7200     | 6900             | 6545     |                  | 6750     |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 2850             | 2900     | 2800             | 2800     |                  | 2750     |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 50               | 45       | 50               | 45       |                  | 45       |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 9950             | 10145    | 9750             | 9390     |                  | 9545     |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 305              | 363      | 254              | 313      |                  | 368      |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 11002            | 11254    | 10604            | 10453    |                  | 10663    |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2025/26

MY 2025/26, rapeseed oil production is forecast to increase due to higher crushing associated with a better rapeseed harvest. Industrial consumption is anticipated to increase, largely due to increased costs and lower availability of alternative feedstocks for biofuels. The December 2025 implementation of EUDR is expected to increase soybean prices in the EU due to compliance costs and used cooking oil methyl ester (UCOME) from China is also anticipated to become more expensive in the EU due to EU antidumping duties imposed on Chinese biodiesel in February 2025 and China's removal of export tax rebates in December 2024. The imposed anti-dumping duties on Chinese biodiesel range between 10 and 35.6 percent. Additionally, several Member States have phased out soy and palm oil-based biofuels counting towards EU renewable energy targets, leaving rapeseed as the primary crop-based biofuel feedstock. EU demand for rapeseed oil is mostly driven by biodiesel and industrial use, with most oil derived from crushing put to this purpose. The EU provides regulatory support for biofuel production through the [Renewable Energy Directive of the EU](#),<sup>3</sup> (RED) however caps are put in place for how much

<sup>3</sup> <https://usda-eu.org/sustainability/bioenergy/>

Member States can count crop-based biofuels towards their RED targets. For more information on RED and EU biofuel policy, please see the website of the Office of Agricultural Affairs at the [U.S. Mission to the European Union](#)<sup>4</sup>. The latest biofuels and biofuels mandate reports may be found in the [USDA Global Agricultural Information Network](#)<sup>5</sup>.

Post anticipates MY 2025/26 food use and exports will remain unchanged year-on-year as increases in production are directed to meet biofuel demand. Imports are anticipated to increase slightly from the low levels seen in MY2024/25 as more supplies are available from foreign suppliers, but will remain below MY 2023/24 levels due to EU import duties placed on Belarus and Russian rapeseed products in July 2024.

### **MY 2024/25**

MY 2024/25 production is estimated to contract significantly due to lower production resulting from a poor rapeseed harvest. Imports are also expected to decline despite lower rapeseed production due to low available foreign supplies and EU import duties on Belarus and Russian rapeseed products. Prior to the imposition of these duties in July 2024, Belarus and Russia accounted for 31 percent of EU rapeseed oil imports in MY 2023/24. After the implementation of duties, imports from Belarus declined 95 percent and imports from Russia declined by over 87 percent, with EU importers turning to Ukraine as an alternative provider.

Industrial use and food use are both anticipated to decline due to lower available supply.

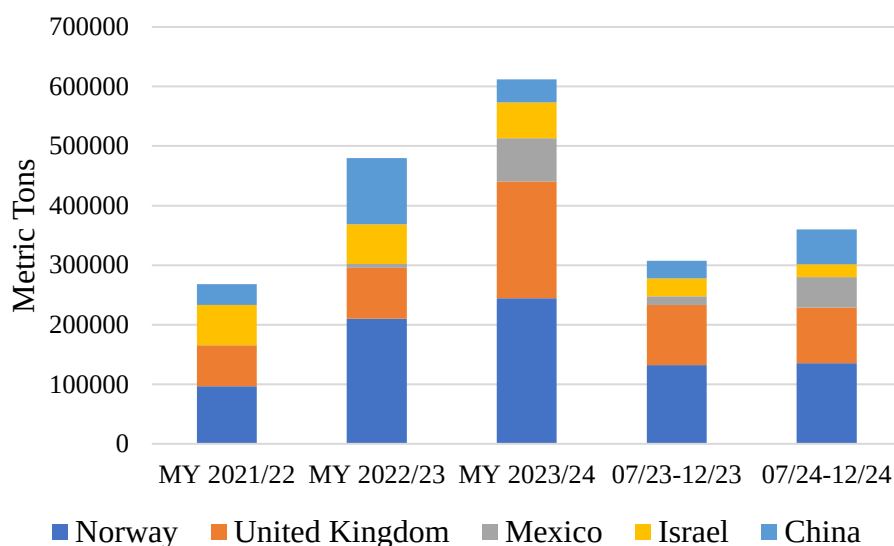
Rapeseed oil exports are expected to flow into the same destination markets as last year. Since MY 2023/24, Mexico has become an increasingly large export market for rapeseed oil from the EU. It is estimated EU exports to Mexico will further increase in MY 2024/25, following a 251 percent increase between July and December 2024 compared to the same period in 2023. This shift towards Mexico is driven by two factors. First, crushers in Mexico have substituted large amounts of rapeseed with cheaper soybeans. This has decreased domestic rapeseed oil supply. Secondly, Canadian rapeseed oil prices are higher than those in the EU, as there is high demand for Canadian rapeseed oil for biofuel production in the United States and Canada. This has made EU rapeseed an affordable alternative for Mexican imports.

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<sup>4</sup> <https://usda-eu.org/>

<sup>5</sup> <https://gain.fas.usda.gov/#/home>

**Figure 15: Main EU Rapeseed Oil Export Destinations (in MT)**



Source: TDM

#### 4. Sunflower Complex

##### Sunflower Seed

**Table 10: Oilseed, Sunflower seed – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Oilseed, Sunflowerseed<br>Market Year Begins                                | 2023/2024        |          | 2024/2025        |          | 2025/2026        |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|
|                                                                             | Oct 2023         |          | Oct 2024         |          | Oct 2025         |          |
| European Union                                                              | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post |
| Area Planted (1000 HA)                                                      | 5200             | 5200     | 4905             | 4900     |                  | 4880     |
| Area Harvested (1000 HA)                                                    | 4798             | 4706     | 4905             | 4870     |                  | 4800     |
| Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)                                                  | 406              | 406      | 678              | 553      |                  | 358      |
| Production (1000 MT)                                                        | 10125            | 10100    | 8780             | 8540     |                  | 10000    |
| MY Imports (1000 MT)                                                        | 828              | 828      | 410              | 700      |                  | 730      |
| Total Supply (1000 MT)                                                      | 11359            | 11334    | 9868             | 9793     |                  | 11088    |
| MY Exports (1000 MT)                                                        | 446              | 446      | 350              | 400      |                  | 530      |
| Crush (1000 MT)                                                             | 9200             | 9300     | 8000             | 8000     |                  | 8960     |
| Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                               | 515              | 515      | 515              | 515      |                  | 515      |
| Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                             | 520              | 520      | 520              | 520      |                  | 520      |
| Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                                  | 10235            | 10335    | 9035             | 9035     |                  | 9995     |
| Ending Stocks (1000 MT)                                                     | 678              | 553      | 483              | 358      |                  | 563      |
| Total Distribution (1000 MT)                                                | 11359            | 11334    | 9868             | 9793     |                  | 11088    |
| Yield (MT/HA)                                                               | 2.1103           | 2.1462   | 1.79             | 1.7536   |                  | 2.0833   |
| (1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)                                               |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |

Source: FAS EU

**MY 2025/26**

Posts forecasts MY 2025/26 production will increase 17 percent year-on-year as yield gains from favorable weather offset production decreases from an anticipated decline in area harvested. MY 2025/26 yields are expected to recover due to improved growing conditions compared to MY 2024/25. Despite an early spring rainfall deficit observed in large parts of central and eastern Europe, the weather currently appears more favorable with improved soil moisture reserves. Average yields are projected to reach roughly 2.08 MT/HA, a 19 percent increase from the year before, although slightly lower than the level achieved two years ago.

MY 2025/26 area harvested is forecast to decline 1.5 percent from MY 2024/25, largely due to an expansion of winter wheat and rapeseed cultivation in sunflower growing areas, particularly in Romania, Spain, and Germany. Area reductions are expected to be largest in Romania where many farmers are anticipated to switch to rapeseed due to attractive rapeseed prices. Sunflower area is anticipated to expand in France, Italy, Hungary, and Bulgaria, however this expansion is not expected to be sufficient to fully offset declines elsewhere. These countries saw ex-farm sunflower prices rise 50 percent from the start of the MY, prompting many growers to switch to sunflower production.

Post anticipates MY 2025/26 crush will increase 12 percent due to improved domestic production, favorable demand conditions, and exportable seed supplies from the Black Sea region. Crush margins are projected to be more attractive than in MY 2024/25 supported by improved demand for sunflower oil on the EU market. The largest crush increases are forecast for Bulgaria, Romania, and Hungary, followed by France, and Germany. Spain is an exception, expecting a small decline while other member-states forecast either stable or slightly higher crush levels. Overall, member-states expect a recovery of about 1.0 MMT in crush compared to MY 2024/25.

Despite a better domestic harvest, imports are forecast to grow 4.3 percent compared to the low levels seen in the current year and to complement local supply and help rebuild record low ending stocks in MY 2024/25. Imports are likely to continue to originate from Ukraine and Moldova which currently expect good sunflower crops. Imports of sunflower seeds are not subject to EUDR unlike soybeans, and this may provide a price advantage for sunflower seeds after EUDR's December 2025 implementation.

Exports of sunflower seeds are likely to grow above the low level seen in the current season. Improved domestic availability may stimulate exports to traditional markets such as Türkiye, most likely from Romania and Bulgaria. Ending stocks are projected to recover, as the EU recovers from lower supplies in MY 2024/25.

**MY 2024/25**

Post estimates a sharp reduction in MY 2024/25 production, down 15.5 percent from the prior year due to poor growing conditions despite an increase in area harvested. Major producing countries were hit hard by summer drought and heat (Romania, Bulgaria, Hungary) and incurred serious losses. In Romania and Bulgaria, yields were further reduced due to reported lower density of plants per hectare. France faced both lower area and excessively wet weather and diseases, affecting crop yields and quality. Italy had a similar situation with decreases in both area and production. According to local sources, crop quality also declined, with a lower oil content negatively impacting crush margins.

In order to compensate for production shortfalls, efforts were made to source sunflower seeds via imports, however, due to low availability of exportable supplies and poor EU crushing margins Post estimates MY 2024/25 imports will decline 15 percent year on year. Local sources report supplies from traditional sources such as Ukraine and Argentina are limited as both countries are prioritizing crushing domestic production over exporting seeds to the EU. The latest [EU Customs](#)<sup>6</sup> data (as of March 13), indicates imports at 435,266 MT, 17 percent lower than last year (based on the EU MY starting from July 1-June 30). More than 60 percent of imports were sourced from Moldova, followed by 11 percent sourced from Serbia.

Post estimates a 14 percent year-on-year drop in MY 2024/25 crush. Driven by a global, regional and local deficit, EU sunflower seed prices have increased considerably, prompting some farmers to hold stocks and further restrict the available supply for crush. Due to high seed prices without a corresponding price increase in sunflower meal or oil (due to competition from soy and rapeseed products), the EU currently has the lowest sunflower crush margins for the last four marketing years. While MY 2024/25 crush started strong with a year-on-year increase of 10 percent from October to December 2024, poor crushing margins have since caused monthly crushing to decline sharply. Many crushers have switched to crushing rapeseed or soybeans which offer higher crushing margins. All EU countries report lower crush this year led by major crushers France, Hungary, Romania, Bulgaria, Spain, and the Netherlands, with a total reported reduction close to 1.3 MMT less than in the previous season. In some countries sunflower crushers have stopped operations and/or are working at a minimal level.

Sunflower seed food use continues to be stable. EU members states report improved application of shelled sunflower seeds in the food industry (bakery, confectionary, in snacks and in baby food) as well as in cooking and in the food service industry. The main driver for this trend is consumer demand for products perceived to offer a healthier lifestyle. Sunflower seeds are appreciated as an affordable quality product, without trans-fats, rich in fiber and protein. Some EU customers are also attracted to sunflowers as a GE-free product. Industry reports indicate that food use in the EU may have an opportunity to grow since dehullers/processors offer more attractive prices to farmers compared to crushers in an effort to source quality product.

Decreased domestic supply in the EU is forecast to negatively impact exports of sunflower seeds. Higher sunflower seed prices driven by production shortages made exports less price competitive and not attractive to price-sensitive buyers. Exports started well in early MY 2023/24 when the sunflower seed prices were still under harvest pressure. In the first quarter of the year, EU exports of sunflower seeds were 35 percent higher than in the corresponding period of the previous season (TDM data). The main markets were Türkiye (36 percent share in total EU exports), the United States (20 percent) and the United Kingdom (15 percent). The top EU exporters were Romania and Bulgaria, followed by Croatia. As of March 13, however, trade flows have declined and exports were 12 percent lower than last year at 323,079 MT (source: [TAXUD](#)<sup>7</sup>). Exports are expected to further decline in the second half of the MY due to shrinking stocks in the EU and noncompetitive export prices.

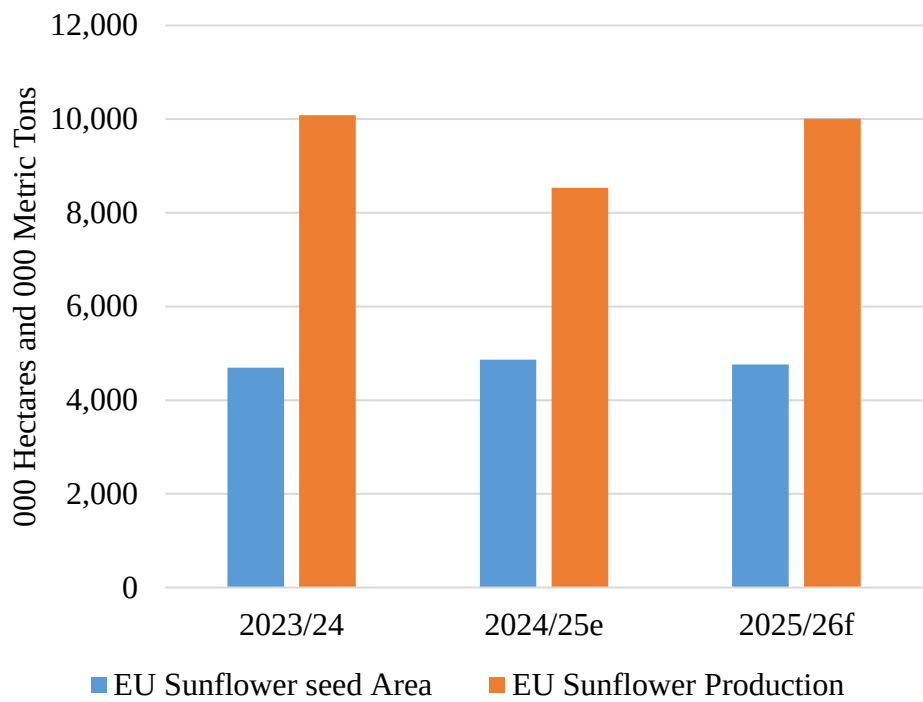
A sharp decline in production and imports are projected to result in lower total supply and record-low ending stocks in MY 2024/25.

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<sup>6</sup> [https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/data-and-analysis/markets/overviews/market-observatories/crops/oilseeds-and-protein-crops\\_en](https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/data-and-analysis/markets/overviews/market-observatories/crops/oilseeds-and-protein-crops_en)

<sup>7</sup> [https://taxation-customs.ec.europa.eu/index\\_en](https://taxation-customs.ec.europa.eu/index_en)

**Figure 16: EU Sunflower Area and Production (in 1000 hectares and 1000 MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast  
Source: FAS EU

## Sunflower Meal

**Table 11: Meal, Sunflower seed – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Meal, Sunflowerseed                                                         | 2023/2024        |             | 2024/2025        |             | 2025/2026        |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|
| Market Year Begins                                                          | Oct 2023         |             | Oct 2024         |             | Oct 2025         |             |
| European Union                                                              | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 9200             | 9300        | 8000             | 8000        |                  | 8960        |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0.5405           | 0.5312      | 0.5405           | 0.54        |                  | 0.5413      |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 311              | 311         | 424              | 441         |                  | 251         |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 4973             | 4940        | 4324             | 4320        |                  | 4850        |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 3156             | 3156        | 2700             | 2500        |                  | 2550        |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 8440             | 8407        | 7448             | 7261        |                  | 7651        |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 956              | 956         | 800              | 600         |                  | 700         |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 60               | 60          | 60               | 60          |                  | 60          |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 7000             | 6950        | 6200             | 6350        |                  | 6600        |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 7060             | 7010        | 6260             | 6410        |                  | 6660        |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 424              | 441         | 388              | 251         |                  | 291         |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 8440             | 8407        | 7448             | 7261        |                  | 7651        |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2025/26

MY 2025/26 meal production is forecast to increase 12.2 percent compared to the current marketing year, reflecting higher crush volumes. Elevated production is projected to be led by Bulgaria, Romania, and Hungary, followed by smaller increases in France and Italy. These increases exceed marginal declines in Spain and the Benelux countries.

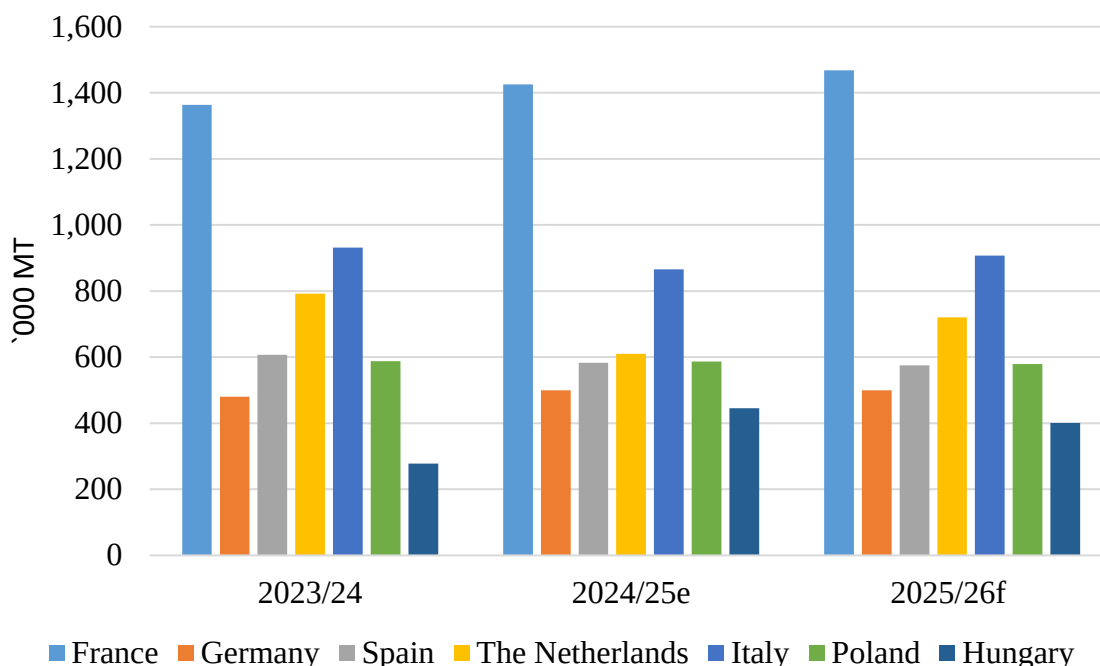
Imports of sunflower meal are forecast to remain steady year-on-year despite higher domestic production due to an anticipated recovery in feed demand and partially to help replenish spent stocks. Sunflower meal is expected to improve its price competitiveness versus rapeseed meal and is likely to benefit against soy meal as it will not face compliance costs from the December 2025 implementation of EUDR. Sunflower meal consumption will continue to be supported by demand for non-GE feed.

EU MY 2025/26 consumption is projected to recover, increasing 4 percent from MY 2024/25 but below the level seen in MY 2023/24. Higher use and incorporation in feed is expected in the Netherlands, France, Italy, Romania and Bulgaria while Spain, Hungary, and Poland project a decrease in use. The other Member States currently report stable use of sunflower meal.



Exports are likely to increase slightly due to better domestic production, but are unlikely to grow significantly due to projected continued competition with Black Sea suppliers. Ending stocks are estimated upwards due to improved total supply. The stocks to use ratio is likely to recover to its average level indicating a more balanced market.

**Figure 17: Top EU Sunflower Meal Consumers (in 1000 MT)**



e = estimate, f = forecast

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2024/25

The EU is estimated to produce significantly lower meal volumes, about 13 percent less than last season, due to reduced crush. Lower production is reported by France, Spain, Italy, Romania, Bulgaria, Hungary and the Netherlands, followed by flat production in Portugal, Germany, Czechia, Greece and Austria.

MY 2024/25 imports are estimated to decline 20 percent year on year, mostly due to lower demand for sunflower meal in feed ratios as this trend is projected to continue in the second half of the current year. Sunflower meal has deteriorated in its price competitiveness versus rival meals, especially soybean meal, leading to weaker demand. Competitiveness with rival meals is not likely to improve later in the marketing year due to abundant global stocks and exportable supplies of soybean meal. The Netherlands, Denmark, Spain, Italy, Latvia, and Bulgaria expect lower imports offsetting projected increases in France, Poland and Romania.

Imports of sunflower meal accelerated in the first quarter of the MY due to low domestic supply and available exportable supplies from Black Sea suppliers early in the season. In the first quarter of the year (TDM data), imports increased by 4 percent compared to the corresponding period in MY 2023/24. The latest [EU Customs](#) data (as of March 13), however, indicates a reversal in imports and a decline to 1.63

MMT, 22 percent less than last year (based on the EU MY running from July 1-June 30). About 66 percent of imports were sourced from Ukraine, followed by 26 percent sourced from Argentina. The top importing Member States were the Netherlands, Poland, France, and Italy.

Post estimates EU sunflower meal consumption will decrease by 8.2 percent compared to MY 2023/24. While sunflower meal was price competitive in the first half of the year, rising prices are expected to make it less attractive in the second half compared to alternative meals and overall consumption is projected to decline. France, Hungary and Germany report higher sunflower meal use; followed by flat consumption in Poland, Benelux and Austria and much lower use in the Netherlands, Denmark, Spain, Italy, Romania, Bulgaria and Greece, offsetting the growth in the above listed countries.

Reduced total supply in the current marketing year is estimated to cause exports to decline by 37 percent compared to the previous season. Additionally, EU exports face tight competition from price-competitive exports from Ukraine and Russia. In the first quarter of the year (TDM data), exports decreased by 44 percent compared to the corresponding period in MY 2023/24. As of March 13, EU exports were at 280,367 MT or 31 percent lower than a year ago (source: [TAXUD](#)). Leading EU exporters were Romania, the Netherlands and Denmark. The top export destinations were the United Kingdom (27 percent), Morocco (23 percent) and Norway (17 percent).

## Sunflower Oil

**Table 12: Oil, Sunflower seed – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Oil, Sunflowerseed<br>Market Year Begins                                    | 2023/2024        |          | 2024/2025        |          | 2025/2026        |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|
|                                                                             | Oct 2023         |          | Oct 2024         |          | Oct 2025         |          |
| European Union                                                              | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 9200             | 9300     | 8000             | 8000     |                  | 8960     |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0.4225           | 0.4237   | 0.4225           | 0.425    |                  | 0.4241   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 292              | 292      | 741              | 704      |                  | 441      |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 3887             | 3940     | 3380             | 3400     |                  | 3800     |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 2965             | 2965     | 2175             | 2250     |                  | 2500     |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 7144             | 7197     | 6296             | 6354     |                  | 6741     |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 990              | 990      | 650              | 750      |                  | 830      |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 550              | 550      | 500              | 550      |                  | 550      |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 4850             | 4940     | 4725             | 4600     |                  | 4850     |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 13               | 13       | 13               | 13       |                  | 13       |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 5413             | 5503     | 5238             | 5163     |                  | 5413     |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 741              | 704      | 408              | 441      |                  | 498      |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 7144             | 7197     | 6296             | 6354     |                  | 6741     |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |

Source: FAS EU

**MY 2025/26**

Sunflower oil production is forecast to increase 11.7 percent due to higher crush. Most Member States expect steady or higher production. The biggest growth is forecast in Bulgaria, Romania, France and Hungary, and to a smaller extent in Italy. This compensates for a small decline in Spain.

Despite better domestic production, imports of sunflower oil are estimated to grow by about 11 percent due to projected favorable demand for food and industrial use and to rebuild very low ending stocks from MY 2024/25.

Food consumption is projected to increase by 5 percent year-on-year. This is due to expected lower prices resulting from higher production, both in direct retail sales, and in the food processing sector, as well as in the hotel, restaurant and institutional (HRI) industries due to thriving tourism and travel. Mediterranean EU countries report a growing preference for sunflower oil in the HRI industry. Sunflower oil continues to be the preferred healthy choice of food edible oil in most countries in Central and Eastern Europe.

EU sunflower oil exports are forecast upward by about 10 percent year-on-year due to better domestic output. However, these exports will likely remain below MY 2023/24 levels due to more favorable local demand and expected competition with supply from the Black Sea region. Ending stocks are estimated to rebound thanks to improved total supply.

**MY 2024/25**

Sunflower oil output is estimated to decrease sharply by 14 percent from the previous season, in line with lower crush volumes. France, Spain, Romania, Bulgaria, Hungary, Italy and the Netherlands report reductions in production; followed by steady output in Germany, Greece, Czechia, Portugal, Austria and Croatia.

MY 2024/25 food consumption is estimated to decline 7 percent year-on-year, largely due to sunflower oil price increases compared to alternative oils, such as rapeseed and soy. Consumer retail sales are anticipated to decrease in part due to competition from lower olive oil prices following a rebound in olive oil production. Sunflower oil also increasingly faces competition for industrial and biodiesel use from other vegetable oils and waste fats such as used cooking oil. Major users such as France, Spain, Benelux, and Poland estimate a decline in use compared to the previous season while stable consumption is reported by Romania, Hungary, Italy, Bulgaria, Portugal, and the Netherlands.

Post anticipates MY 2024/25 imports will decline 24 percent year-on-year due to lower exportable supplies from traditional suppliers such as Ukraine. Although imports in the first quarter of the year were 11 percent higher than in the corresponding period last year (TDM data), imports have shrunk fast and as of March 13 (source: [TAXUD](#)) were at 1.4 MMT, 23 percent lower than last year. Ukraine has been the major supplier of sunflower oil to the EU to date (94 percent). High prices may attract some imports from other providers (for example Argentina). According to EU Customs, leading EU importers to date are Spain, the Netherlands, Italy, Bulgaria, and Slovenia, although much of these imports are likely transshipped. France, Romania, Bulgaria, Portugal, and Greece expect small increases in imports while all other Member States project lower imports.

Exports of sunflower oil are estimated to decline due to reduced supply and stronger competition from the Black Sea region. In the first quarter of MY 2024/25, exports decreased by 37 percent compared to a year ago (TDM data). As of March 13, exports were reported at 30 percent lower than last year (source: [TAXUD](#)) to the United Kingdom (27 percent), India, (14 percent), and the United States (9 percent). Major EU exporters are reported to be France, Spain, Finland, Hungary, Bulgaria and Romania.

Ending stocks are projected to decline sharply compared to MY 2023/24 percent due to lower total supply. The resulting very low stocks to use ratio indicates a tight market and corresponds to the higher price levels seen on the market in the current season.

## 5. Palm Kernel Complex

### Palm Kernel Meal

**Table 13: Meal, Palm Kernel – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Meal, Palm Kernel<br>Market Year Begins         | 2023/2024        |             | 2024/2025        |             | 2025/2026        |             |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|
|                                                 | Jan 2024         |             | Jan 2025         |             | Jan 2026         |             |
|                                                 | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post |
| <b>European Union</b>                           |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                          | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Extr. Rate,</b><br><b>999.9999</b> (PERCENT) | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)               | 23               | 23          | 37               | 12          |                  | 47          |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                     | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                     | 1,555            | 1,555       | 1,350            | 1,350       |                  | 950         |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                   | 1,578            | 1,578       | 1,387            | 1,362       |                  | 997         |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                     | 16               | 16          | 20               | 15          |                  | 12          |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)          | 450              | 450         | 450              | 450         |                  | 350         |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)            | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)          | 1,075            | 1,100       | 885              | 850         |                  | 600         |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)               | 1,525            | 1,550       | 1,335            | 1,300       |                  | 950         |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                  | 37               | 12          | 32               | 47          |                  | 35          |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)             | 1,578            | 1,578       | 1,387            | 1,362       |                  | 997         |
| (1000 MT), (PERCENT)                            |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |

OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: [PSD Online Advanced Query](#)

Source: FAS EU

**Table 14: Oil, Palm Kernel – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Oil, Palm Kernel<br>Market Year Begins<br><br>European Union                | 2023/2024        |             | 2024/2025        |             | 2025/2026        |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|
|                                                                             | Jan 2024         |             | Jan 2025         |             | Jan 2026         |             |
|                                                                             | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Extr. Rate,</b><br><b>999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                             | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 78               | 78          | 101              | 81          |                  | 84          |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 609              | 609         | 500              | 610         |                  | 570         |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 687              | 687         | 601              | 691         |                  | 654         |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 11               | 11          | 10               | 12          |                  | 12          |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000<br>MT)                                   | 275              | 275         | 250              | 275         |                  | 250         |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000<br>MT)                                     | 300              | 320         | 250              | 320         |                  | 310         |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000<br>MT)                                   | 0                | 0           | 0                | 0           |                  | 0           |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 575              | 595         | 500              | 595         |                  | 560         |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 101              | 81          | 91               | 84          |                  | 82          |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 687              | 687         | 601              | 691         |                  | 654         |
| (1000 MT), (PERCENT)                                                        |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |

Source: FAS EU

EU palm kernel meal imports fell from 1.64 MMT in 2023 to 1.56 MMT in 2024 due to lower global supply and reduced EU demand. Palm kernel meal is commonly the cheapest of the four leading oilseed meals (i.e., soybean, rapeseed, sunflower, and palm kernel). It is mainly used as cattle feed, but also as swine feed (in particular for sows). In 2025, EU imports and use are forecast to continue to decline based on an overall shrinkage of the EU cattle herd (for more information see the [EU Livestock Semi-Annual of 2025](#)) and an ample supply of soybean meal. In 2026, palm kernel meal is anticipated to face more competition from domestic and imported supplies of rapeseed meal and sunflower seed meal. Almost two-thirds of imported palm kernel meal is used in the Netherlands. However, because the Dutch dairy herd is on the decline, Dutch consumption is forecast to decrease. A potential growth market is Central Europe, where the cattle herd has the capacity to expand, but this region is commonly not a market for palm kernel meal.

In 2024, EU palm kernel oil imports stabilized at 0.61 MMT. Increased imports were reported from both Malaysia and Indonesia. EU imports stabilized despite lower global supply, partly due to high prices quoted for palm oil during 2024. After a further stabilization in 2025, imports are forecast to decline in 2026 largely due to compliance costs associated with the December 2025 implementation of EUDR, which will affect both palm kernel meal and palm kernel oil imports. A yet unknown portion of EU

imports are expected to be compliant as both products are derived from the palm oil sector and both commodities are expected to face higher compliance costs. For more information see the Palm Oil and the Policy chapter of this report.

## 6. Palm Oil

### Palm Oil

**Table 15: Oil, Palm – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| <b>Oil, Palm</b>                                                            | <b>2023/2024</b>     |                 | <b>2024/2025</b>     |                 | <b>2025/2026</b>     |                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Market Year Begins</b>                                                   | <b>Jan 2024</b>      |                 | <b>Jan 2025</b>      |                 | <b>Jan 2026</b>      |                 |
| <b>European Union</b>                                                       | <b>USDA Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> |
| <b>Area Planted</b> (1000 HA)                                               | 0                    | 0               | 0                    | 0               |                      | 0               |
| <b>Area Harvested</b> (1000 HA)                                             | 0                    | 0               | 0                    | 0               |                      | 0               |
| <b>Trees</b> (1000 TREES)                                                   | 0                    | 0               | 0                    | 0               |                      | 0               |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 610                  | 610             | 462                  | 773             |                      | 678             |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 0                    | 0               | 0                    | 0               |                      | 0               |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 3,820                | 3,820           | 4,000                | 3,300           |                      | 3,150           |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 4,430                | 4,430           | 4,462                | 4,073           |                      | 3,828           |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 138                  | 137             | 120                  | 135             |                      | 130             |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 1,800                | 1,390           | 1,750                | 1,170           |                      | 1,130           |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 1,900                | 2,000           | 2,000                | 1,970           |                      | 1,960           |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 130                  | 130             | 100                  | 120             |                      | 120             |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 3,830                | 3,520           | 3,850                | 3,260           |                      | 3,210           |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 462                  | 773             | 492                  | 678             |                      | 488             |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 4,430                | 4,430           | 4,462                | 4,073           |                      | 3,828           |
| (1000 HA), (1000 TREES), (1000 MT)                                          |                      |                 |                      |                 |                      |                 |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                      |                 |                      |                 |                      |                 |

Source: FAS EU

Post anticipates that EU MY 2024/25 and 2025/26 palm oil imports will continue to decline as several Member States phase out palm oil for biofuel use, consumers increasingly turn to alternative oils due to perceived health concerns, palm oil loses price competitiveness in the feed sector against other oils, and the 2025 implementation of EUDR raises compliance costs.

In 2024, the EU reduced its import volume of palm oil for the fourth successive year, from 7.11 MMT in 2020 to 3.82 MMT, the lowest volume reported since 2006. In absolute terms, the most significant cuts were reported for imports from Indonesia and Guatemala. Imports from Indonesia were hit particularly hard due to the implementation of export taxes by the Indonesian government to curb domestic price inflation (for more information see the [Oilseeds and Products Update for Indonesia](#), published February

25, 2025). Overall, the ranking of the top 3 suppliers of Indonesia, Malaysia, and Guatemala remained unchanged. While imports of refined palm oil have been fluctuating around the 2.0 MMT since 2014 (2.08 MMT in 2024), imports of crude palm oil have been falling from 7.07 MMT in 2019 to 1.81 MMT in 2024.

Since 2020, the main reductions of both total and crude palm oil imports, have been reported for Spain, the Netherlands, Italy, Belgium, France, and Germany. These EU Member States reduced crude palm oil imports because of European Commission (EC) regulations which aim to cut the use of virgin vegetable oils to produce biofuels and increase the proportion of used fats and oils. Other feedstocks the EC regulation supports are by-products from oilseed harvesting, crushing, and vegetable oil refining. Biofuels produced from such feedstocks count double against the blending mandates in many Member States. Palm oil use is also affected by the phase-out of biofuels derived from high-risk ILUC (Indirect Land Use Change) crops (see the Policy and Programs chapter of this report). According to the [EU Renewable Energy Directive II](#)<sup>8</sup> (REDII) and [EU Delegated Act 2019/807](#)<sup>9</sup>, the use of high-risk ILUC biofuels is capped at the 2019 level until 2023 and then will be phased out by 2030. It must be noted that the delegated act provides the possibility for producers to certify their feedstock as low-risk ILUC.

Several Member States have announced earlier phase-outs of palm oil than laid down in the REDII. In 2021, the French State Council confirmed that biofuels produced from all palm oil-based products are excluded from a tax advantage. Austria, Belgium, the Netherlands, Germany, Denmark, Sweden, Finland, and Italy reportedly followed with the accelerated phase out of palm oil as feedstock for biofuel production. However, these national bans only affect the consumption and not production. Therefore, palm oil-based biofuels can still be produced in Member States with a ban but will have to be exported either to another Member State market or outside the EU.

Indonesia (in 2019) and Malaysia (2021) filed a complaint at the WTO accusing the EU of restricting imports of palm oil as feedstock to produce biofuels. Recently the WTO [confirmed](#)<sup>10</sup> the overall WTO compatibility of the RED II legal framework, albeit noting that certain aspects of the implementation and design of an EU Delegated Act under the Directive were inconsistent with WTO rules. For more information about the use of palm oil for the production of biofuels see the [EU Biofuels Annual of 2024](#), published August 13, 2024.

Based on the phasing out of palm oil, the use as feedstock for biofuel production is forecast to further fall from 0.39 MMT in 2024 to 0.22 MMT in 2025 and 0.21 MMT in 2026. At the same time, EU imports of by-products of the palm oil sector, mainly palm fatty acid distillate (PFAD) and palm oil mill effluent (POME), have increased significantly since 2020, in particular by the Netherlands. However, in January 2025, the Government of Indonesia [enacted](#) a new regulation to curb exports of palm waste products such as POME. Other feedstocks replacing crude palm oil for biofuels production, and increasingly imported by the EU, are used cooking oil (UCO) and tall oil (for more information see the GAIN report - [United States Tall Oil Exports to the Nordics Surge](#), published November 6, 2024). A large portion of the alternative feedstocks are sourced domestically such as byproducts from vegetable oil refining and brown grease. The biofuels sector is also experimenting with so-called novel vegetable

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<sup>8</sup> [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=uriserv:OJ.L\\_.2018.328.01.0082.01.ENG&toc=OJ:L:2018:328:TOC](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=uriserv:OJ.L_.2018.328.01.0082.01.ENG&toc=OJ:L:2018:328:TOC)

<sup>9</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?qid=1558622442666&uri=CELEX:32019R0807>

<sup>10</sup> [https://policy.trade.ec.europa.eu/news/wto-confirms-validity-eu-climate-based-actions-renewable-energy-dispute-brought-indonesia-2025-01-10\\_en](https://policy.trade.ec.europa.eu/news/wto-confirms-validity-eu-climate-based-actions-renewable-energy-dispute-brought-indonesia-2025-01-10_en)



oils produced from rotation crops such as winter canola, which are listed as intermediate crops in Part A of Annex IX of the [REDII](#).

Since mid-2024, palm oil prices have risen significantly and palm oil lost its competitiveness with soybean and rapeseed oil. As a result, EU food use of palm oil declined in 2024, and is forecast to decline further based on improved availability of other vegetable oils, such as rapeseed oil, sunflower oil, and olive oil. The relatively high price of palm oil also negatively affected feed use. Reportedly palm oil has been partly replaced by corn oil in compound feed formulations. In the EU, palm oil is widely deemed to be unhealthy due to its high level of saturated fat (food manufacturers advertise the absence of palm oil as a key selling point on their product packaging). However, it is an essential ingredient for many food products, and often difficult to replace by other vegetable oils. In addition, the use by the food service industry is forecast to stabilize in 2025 and 2026 due to the lack of labeling. In addition to perceived health benefits, sustainability certification is another important factor for acceptance in the food market. The private sectors in the Netherlands, Belgium, Germany, Italy, France, Denmark, and Sweden agreed to ensure a fully certified, sustainable palm oil supply in Europe by 2020. In 2021 (latest data available), 93 percent of European imported palm oil was certified as sustainable (for more information see the Palm Oil Report of the Sustainable Trade Initiative).

As part of the European Green Deal, the EU will enforce the [EUDR](#)<sup>11</sup> on December 30, 2025. This regulation will establish rules for commodities identified as the main drivers to deforestation and forest degradation, namely: cattle, cocoa, coffee, palm oil, rubber, soy, and wood. The concerns of EU importers of these commodities are similar to that of palm oil producers' organizations and are mainly related to the geolocation and traceability elements of the EUDR, in particular for palm oil shipments sourced from small plots and many landowners that are aggregated and transported in bulk. FAS EU Posts anticipate that a portion of the palm oil supply will be in compliance with the EUDR but that the volume will be limited, and the sourcing will come at a cost. For more information about the EUDR see the FAS GAIN Report: [European Institutions Finalize Deforestation-Free Supply Chain Regulation](#), published by Brussels USEU on January 12, 2023. Due to the lower use by the food sector and biofuel industry, EU imports are forecast to fall to 3.30 MMT in 2025, and 3.15 MMT in 2026. Palm oil stocks are anticipated to decline in line with the lower supply. A large share of the stocked volume is stored in the port of Rotterdam, where storage capacity for edible oils is estimated at roughly 1.2 MMT.

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<sup>11</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32023R1115&qid=1687867231461>



## 7. Peanut Complex

**Table 16: Oilseed, Peanut – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Oilseed, Peanut                                                             | 2023/2024        |             | 2024/2025        |             | 2025/2026        |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|
| Market Year Begins                                                          | Oct 2023         |             | Oct 2024         |             | Oct 2025         |             |
| European Union                                                              | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post | USDA<br>Official | New<br>Post |
| Area Planted (1000 HA)                                                      | 0                | 1           | 0                | 1           |                  | 1           |
| Area Harvested (1000 HA)                                                    | 0                | 1           | 0                | 1           |                  | 1           |
| Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)                                                  | 54               | 54          | 37               | 53          |                  | 61          |
| Production (1000 MT)                                                        | 0                | 1           | 0                | 1           |                  | 1           |
| MY Imports (1000 MT)                                                        | 866              | 870         | 920              | 920         |                  | 910         |
| Total Supply (1000 MT)                                                      | 920              | 925         | 957              | 974         |                  | 972         |
| MY Exports (1000 MT)                                                        | 65               | 64          | 45               | 65          |                  | 60          |
| Crush (1000 MT)                                                             | 35               | 35          | 35               | 35          |                  | 35          |
| Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                               | 780              | 770         | 835              | 810         |                  | 815         |
| Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                             | 3                | 3           | 3                | 3           |                  | 3           |
| Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)                                                  | 818              | 808         | 873              | 848         |                  | 853         |
| Ending Stocks (1000 MT)                                                     | 37               | 53          | 39               | 61          |                  | 59          |
| Total Distribution (1000 MT)                                                | 920              | 925         | 957              | 974         |                  | 972         |
| Yield (MT/HA)                                                               | 0                | 1           | 0                | 1           |                  | 1           |
| (1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)                                               |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |             |                  |             |                  |             |

Source: FAS EU (data presented on an ‘in-shell’ basis)

Following previous increases, domestic food use consumption is expected to be little changed between MY2024/25 and 2025/26, with consumer tastes and preferences seemingly largely unchanged. The demand for peanuts from the food manufacturing sector is driven by consumer demand for healthier snacking options – particularly products that have no additives/preservatives, are sugar-free, or “all-natural.” In MY2023/24, the main supplier to the EU of shelled peanuts remains Argentina with around 48 percent market share. However, the widely reported crop issues experienced in Argentina in 2023 led to their exports to the EU declining by almost 200,000 MT, over 22 percent of its total global export volume. This downturn was partially offset by increased exports from the United States, which were up by around 88,000 MT, to almost 175,000 MT in MY2023/24. The largest U.S. export markets within the EU were the Netherlands, Germany and Spain.

Based on trade data for the first quarter of MY2024/25, the Argentinian market share appears to be returning to prior historical levels. A significant increase in Chinese exports over the same three months means they are close to the United States as the second largest supplier to the EU, with both having a market share of around 7 percent in December 2024. Exports of peanuts from the United States have faced both strong competition from other suppliers and increased import controls for aflatoxin detections since late 2021. For comparison, the U.S. market share was 25 percent in MY2013/14 and while EU

imports have grown by more than 200,000 MT since then, the U.S. has not been able to capitalize proportionately on this expanded market, with a share of less than 10 percent in most of the recent years. Industry sources suggest the upturn in Argentinian production is likely to see stocks replenished.

Exports of U.S. peanuts remain dependent on the ease with which U.S. suppliers can meet EU requirements for pesticide residues, aflatoxin levels, phytosanitary certificates, and private industry standards.

**Table 17: Meal, Peanut – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| <b>Meal, Peanut</b>                                                         | <b>2023/2024</b>         |                 | <b>2024/2025</b>         |                 | <b>2025/2026</b>         |                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Market Year Begins</b>                                                   | <b>Oct 2023</b>          |                 | <b>Oct 2024</b>          |                 | <b>Oct 2025</b>          |                 |
| <b>European Union</b>                                                       | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 35                       | 35              | 35                       | 35              |                          | 35              |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0.4286                   | 0.4286          | 0.4286                   | 0.4286          |                          | 0.4286          |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 15                       | 15              | 15                       | 15              |                          | 15              |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 15                       | 15              | 15                       | 15              |                          | 15              |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 15                       | 15              | 15                       | 15              |                          | 15              |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 15                       | 15              | 15                       | 15              |                          | 15              |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 0                        | 0               | 0                        | 0               |                          | 0               |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 15                       | 15              | 15                       | 15              |                          | 15              |
| <b>(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)</b>                                                 |                          |                 |                          |                 |                          |                 |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                          |                 |                          |                 |                          |                 |

Source: FAS EU

Peanut crushing within the EU has not increased in recent years and there is currently a preference for other meals for animal feed. For this reason, little change is expected in MY2025/26.

**Table 18: Oil, Peanut – Production, Supply and Distribution**

| Oil, Peanut<br>Market Year Begins<br><br>European Union                     | 2023/2024        |          | 2024/2025        |          | 2025/2026        |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|------------------|----------|
|                                                                             | Oct 2023         |          | Oct 2024         |          | Oct 2025         |          |
|                                                                             | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post | USDA<br>Official | New Post |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 35               | 35       | 35               | 35       |                  | 35       |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0.3714           | 0.3714   | 0.3714           | 0.3714   |                  | 0.3714   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 3                | 3        | 4                | 3        |                  | 4        |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 13               | 13       | 13               | 13       |                  | 13       |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 45               | 45       | 55               | 55       |                  | 50       |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 61               | 61       | 72               | 71       |                  | 67       |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 7                | 7        | 6                | 6        |                  | 6        |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 0                | 0        | 0                | 0        |                  | 0        |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 50               | 51       | 62               | 61       |                  | 57       |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 0                | 0        | 0                | 0        |                  | 0        |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 50               | 51       | 62               | 61       |                  | 57       |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 4                | 3        | 4                | 4        |                  | 4        |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 61               | 61       | 72               | 71       |                  | 67       |
| (1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)                                                        |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                  |          |                  |          |                  |          |

Source: FAS EU

Imports are anticipated to slightly decline from MY2023/24 as peanut oil declines in importance in the EU due to allergen concerns. Peanut oil must be labeled on EU food packaging as an allergen. The allergen designation for peanut oil deters widespread use of the product in food manufacturing in the EU. For this reason, EU peanut oil consumption has declined in the last ten years and is increasingly substituted by other types of oils. Brazil remains the leading supplier of peanut oil to the EU followed by Nicaragua and Argentina.

## 8. Fish Meal

### Fish Meal

**Table 19: Meal, Fish – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Meal, Fish                                                                  | 2023/2024     |          | 2024/2025     |          | 2025/2026     |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
| Market Year Begins                                                          | Jan 2024      |          | Jan 2025      |          | Jan 2026      |          |
| European Union                                                              | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 0             | 0        | 0             | 0        |               | 0        |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 400           | 400      | 400           | 390      |               | 385      |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 200           | 200      | 245           | 190      |               | 185      |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 600           | 600      | 645           | 580      |               | 570      |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 171           | 171      | 180           | 160      |               | 155      |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 0             | 0        | 0             | 0        |               | 0        |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 0             | 0        | 0             | 0        |               | 0        |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 429           | 429      | 465           | 420      |               | 415      |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 429           | 429      | 465           | 420      |               | 415      |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 0             | 0        | 0             | 0        |               | 0        |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 600           | 600      | 645           | 580      |               | 570      |
| (1000 MT)                                                                   |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |               |          |               |          |               |          |

Source: FAS EU

During the past decade, the EU produced between 400,000 MT and 500,000 MT of fishmeal and between 120,000 MT to 190,000 MT of fish oil. Over the long term, EU fishmeal production has shown a declining trend. Denmark is the leading producer in the EU, contributing to about 50 percent of total production, while Spain ranks as the second-largest producer. Spanish production is mainly derived from by-products from fish processing, while Danish production volumes depend on fishery [quotas](#)<sup>12</sup> set by the European Commission (EC), as well as the actual [catch](#)<sup>13</sup> (Danish language). In 2024, Danish landings of fish for fishmeal production declined about 10 percent, mainly due lower landings of sandeel, and, to a lesser extent, sprat. Based on a larger quota, landings of blue whiting increased. In 2025 and 2026, EU fishmeal production is forecast to fall to 390,000 MT and 385,000 MT respectively. This forecast is mainly based on reduced quotas for industrial fish landings in 2025 and an anticipated further reduction in 2026.

From 2014 to 2024, EU consumption of fishmeal has declined by approximately 20 percent now standing at around 430,000 MT. The size of the aquaculture industry (globally the largest buyer of

<sup>12</sup> <https://effop.org/resources/tacs-and-quotas/>

<sup>13</sup> <https://fiskeristyrelsen.dk/>

fishmeal) in the EU, is limited compared to Norway and the United Kingdom (Scotland), which are both not EU Members. In the EU, aquaculture is predominantly practiced in the Mediterranean (Greece, Spain, Italy) but its growth is stagnating. At the same time, the demand for fishmeal by the swine sector as an ingredient for piglet feed is dwindling due to declining EU pork production and increasing competition with soybean meal and other oilseed and grain derivatives as protein source. Post anticipates 2025 and 2026 feed use will decline slightly, reflecting this trend. The difference between imports and exports fluctuates yearly, depending on domestic production and the world supply of fishmeal. Nevertheless, the EU remains a net importer of fishmeal. The five main suppliers of fishmeal to the EU are Morocco, Norway, Faroe Islands, Iceland, and Chile. Since the past five years, Peru fell from the first ranking supplier to number seven, due to the lower landings in Peru as well as its increased export focus on China. The top three export destinations for fishmeal are Norway, the United Kingdom, and China.

## 9. Copra Complex

### Coconut Oil

**Table 20: Oil, Coconut – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| <b>Oil, Coconut</b>                                                         | <b>2023/2024</b>         |                     | <b>2024/2025</b>         |                     | <b>2025/2026</b>         |                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Market Year Begins</b>                                                   | <b>Jan 2024</b>          |                     | <b>Jan 2025</b>          |                     | <b>Jan 2026</b>          |                     |
| <b>European Union</b>                                                       | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New<br/>Post</b> | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New<br/>Post</b> | <b>USDA<br/>Official</b> | <b>New<br/>Post</b> |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                                                      | 0                        | 0                   | 0                        | 0                   |                          | 0                   |
| <b>Extr. Rate, 999.9999</b> (PERCENT)                                       | 0                        | 0                   | 0                        | 0                   |                          | 0                   |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 81                       | 81                  | 69                       | 86                  |                          | 82                  |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 0                        | 0                   | 0                        | 0                   |                          | 0                   |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 637                      | 646                 | 645                      | 640                 |                          | 625                 |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 718                      | 727                 | 714                      | 726                 |                          | 707                 |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 24                       | 11                  | 30                       | 15                  |                          | 11                  |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 260                      | 260                 | 260                      | 260                 |                          | 260                 |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 365                      | 365                 | 365                      | 365                 |                          | 365                 |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 0                        | 5                   | 0                        | 4                   |                          | 4                   |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 625                      | 630                 | 625                      | 629                 |                          | 629                 |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 69                       | 86                  | 59                       | 82                  |                          | 67                  |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 718                      | 727                 | 714                      | 726                 |                          | 707                 |
| <b>(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)</b>                                                 |                          |                     |                          |                     |                          |                     |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |                          |                     |                          |                     |                          |                     |

Source: FAS EU

The EU is a major global buyer of coconut oil, valued for its use as a healthier alternative in cooking and in producing high-end health foods, snacks, and supplements. Its moisturizing properties also make it a popular ingredient in cosmetics. Around 70 percent of the EU's coconut oil imports come from the Philippines.

In MY 2025/26, a slightly tighter EU supply balance is anticipated due to a reduction in the Philippines' exportable supply, caused by two key factors: lower production and increased Philippine use of coconut oil in biofuel production.

Coconut production in the Philippines is forecast to decline in MY 2025/26 as the El Niño phenomenon adversely impacts yields. Additionally, updated biofuel legislation, effective October 2024, introduced a new B3 mandate. An expected increase to a B4 blending mandate in October 2025 will slightly boost domestic demand for coconut oil, further reducing exportable supply. For example, in Q4 2024, approximately 83,000 MT of coconut oil was needed to increase the blending ratio from 3 to 4 percent.

Despite these challenges, EU demand for coconut oil remains high. EUDR and the Renewable Energy Directive (RED II) have made importing palm oil more difficult and costly, positioning coconut oil as the closest substitute for industrial and food processing purposes.

## 10. Cottonseed

**Table 21: Cottonseed, Seed – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| <b>Oilseed, Cottonseed</b>                  | <b>2023/2024</b>     |                 | <b>2024/2025</b>     |                 | <b>2025/2026</b>     |                 |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Market Year Begins</b>                   | <b>Oct 2023</b>      |                 | <b>Oct 2024</b>      |                 | <b>Oct 2025</b>      |                 |
| <b>European Union</b>                       | <b>USDA Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> | <b>USDA Official</b> | <b>New Post</b> |
| <b>Area Harvested (Cotton)</b><br>(1000 HA) | 254                  | 254             | 274                  | 274             |                      | 265             |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)           | 53                   | 53              | 65                   | 65              |                      | 64              |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                 | 334                  | 340             | 403                  | 414             |                      | 400             |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                 | 4                    | 4               | 0                    | 0               |                      | 0               |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)               | 391                  | 397             | 468                  | 479             |                      | 464             |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                 | 46                   | 46              | 75                   | 80              |                      | 75              |
| <b>Crush</b> (1000 MT)                      | 155                  | 161             | 185                  | 190             |                      | 190             |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b><br>(1000 MT)     | 0                    | 0               | 0                    | 0               |                      | 0               |
| <b>Feed Waste Dom. Cons.</b><br>(1000 MT)   | 125                  | 125             | 145                  | 145             |                      | 145             |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)           | 280                  | 286             | 330                  | 335             |                      | 335             |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)              | 65                   | 65              | 63                   | 64              |                      | 54              |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)         | 391                  | 397             | 468                  | 479             |                      | 464             |
| <b>Yield</b> (MT/HA)                        | 1.315                | 1.339           | 1.471                | 1.511           |                      | 1.509           |
| (1000 HA), (RATIO), (1000 MT), (MT/HA)      |                      |                 |                      |                 |                      |                 |

Source: FAS EU

## **Production**

The European Union is a minor producer of cotton, representing approximately 1.5 percent of global production. EU cotton production has declined by more than 50 percent since the implementation of the 2006 Common Agricultural Policy that decoupled payments from production and reduced support for a number of crops, including cotton. Furthermore, the EU ban on modern biotech cotton cultivation reduces Member States' competitiveness in the global cotton market. Only two EU Members States, Greece and Spain grow significant volumes of cotton for commercial use.

While cottonseed production rebounded in MY 2024/25, it is expected to decline slightly in MY 2025/26 due to lower cultivation area. Average yields in Greece and Spain are forecast for MY 2025/26 but could drop if production input costs continue to rise and water for irrigation remains limited. The record rainfall registered throughout March 2025 has secured water supply for MY2025/26 cotton irrigation needs.

## **Crush**

Approximately 55 percent of cottonseed production in Greece is crushed for oil (and oilseed cake) with the remaining volume utilized for animal feed and seeding. In Spain, there is no domestic cottonseed crushing. In 2025, Greek crush is largely unchanged from the previous year, due to similar production levels. Roughly 20 percent of cottonseed oil goes to biodiesel production while the majority is used for food and snack manufacturing and frying oil for restaurants.

## **Trade**

In MY 2023/24, EU cottonseed exports were limited due to lower production and average yields but look to rebound by the end of MY 2024/25 and remain at similar levels in MY 2025/26 driven by greater supply availability. Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Japan, and Qatar are the leading destinations for EU cottonseed exports. Greece imports small amounts of cottonseed for blending into its domestic crushing industry.

## 11. Olive Oil

### Olive Oil

**Table 22: Oil, Olive – Production, Supply, and Distribution**

| Oil, Olive                                                                  | 2023/2024     |          | 2024/2025     |          | 2025/2026     |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|---------------|----------|
| Market Year Begins                                                          | Nov 2023      |          | Nov 2024      |          | Nov 2025      |          |
| European Union                                                              | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post | USDA Official | New Post |
| <b>Beginning Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 210           | 210      | 188           | 199      |               | 334      |
| <b>Production</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 1,525         | 1,532    | 1,950         | 2,080    |               | 1,980    |
| <b>MY Imports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 230           | 203      | 200           | 215      |               | 215      |
| <b>Total Supply</b> (1000 MT)                                               | 1,965         | 1,945    | 2,338         | 2,494    |               | 2,529    |
| <b>MY Exports</b> (1000 MT)                                                 | 687           | 606      | 675           | 725      |               | 730      |
| <b>Industrial Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                      | 15            | 15       | 20            | 20       |               | 20       |
| <b>Food Use Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                        | 1,075         | 1,125    | 1,320         | 1,415    |               | 1,420    |
| <b>Total Dom. Cons.</b> (1000 MT)                                           | 1,090         | 1,140    | 1,340         | 1,435    |               | 1,440    |
| <b>Ending Stocks</b> (1000 MT)                                              | 188           | 199      | 323           | 334      |               | 359      |
| <b>Total Distribution</b> (1000 MT)                                         | 1,965         | 1,945    | 2,338         | 2,494    |               | 2,529    |
| (1000 HA) (1000 TREES) ,(1000 MT)                                           |               |          |               |          |               |          |
| OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: <a href="#">PSD Online Advanced Query</a> |               |          |               |          |               |          |

Note: Post trade and production data include only HS Code 1509.

Source: FAS EU

### MY 2025/26

In this report, projections for MY 2025/26 are based on five-year average numbers, as it is too early to estimate MY 2025/26 while the MY 2024/25 harvest is just finishing.<sup>14</sup> Based on these projections, Post anticipates MY 2025/26 production to remain above MY 2023/24 levels, facilitating robust exports and consumption. Olive oil yields are a factor of spring temperatures during tree blooming (April and May) and fall precipitation patterns. Other yield factors that come into play include olive trees' alternative bearing cycles and access to irrigation.<sup>15</sup>

The EU is the world's largest olive oil producer, accounting for over 60 percent of global production. The main olive oil producers in the EU include Spain, which produces nearly 70 percent of the bloc's olive oil output, followed by other major producers, including Italy, Greece, and Portugal. To a much smaller extent, olive oil production also exists in France, Cyprus, Croatia, and Slovenia.

<sup>14</sup> Olive harvest for milling purposes in the EU runs from late October until April although the bulk of the production is normally harvested between November and February.

<sup>15</sup> Olive trees have biannual yield cycles (recurring "up" and "down" years) that cause variation in production from year to year. The impact of these yield cycles can be lessened through irrigation.

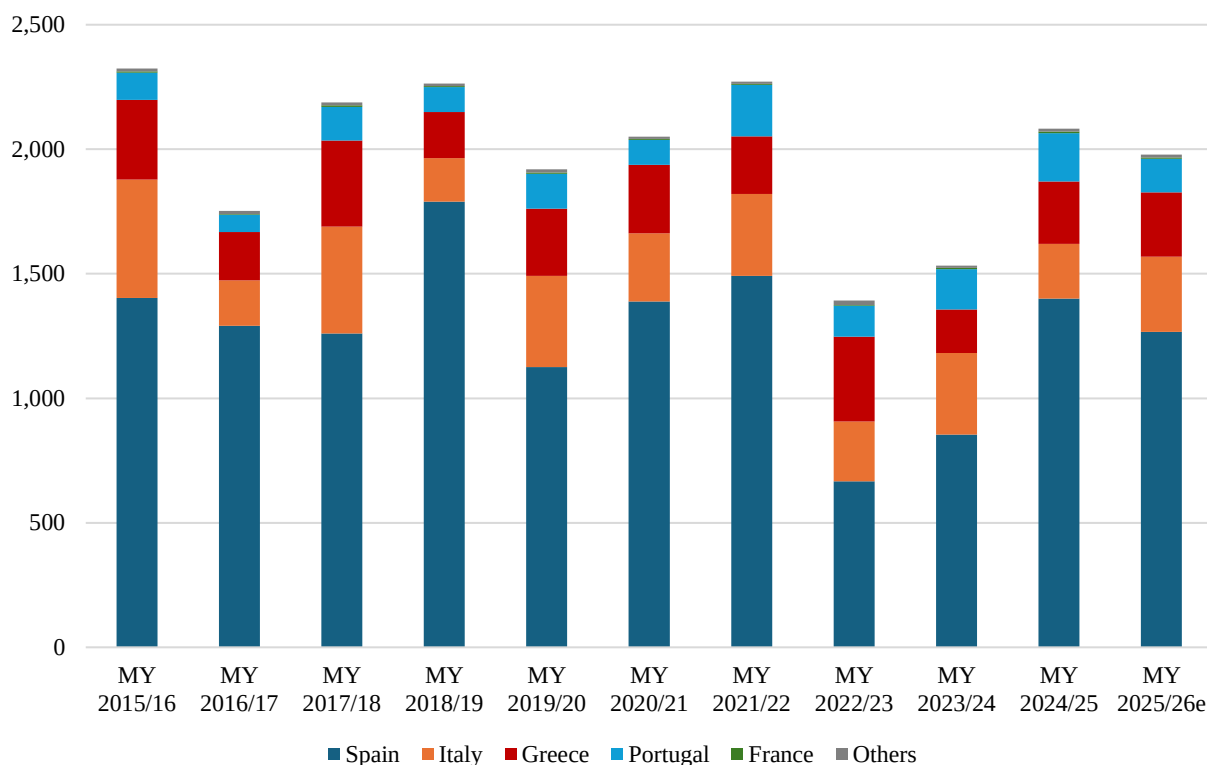


## MY 2024/25

EU olive oil production for MY 2024/25 is estimated at over 2 million MT, a 30 percent increase from MY 2023/24 levels due to good growing conditions in Spain and Greece.

In Spain and Greece, favorable fall conditions allowed for an improved harvest compared to the November forecast in GAIN Report [European Union: EU Olive Oil Production Update](#). In Spain, late winter precipitations are extending the harvest season and are also expected to contribute to an increase in production levels. In the case of Portugal, new modern plantations entering production have resulted in improved output compared to Post's November figures. In Italy, production is expected to decrease from MY 2023/24 levels due to a combination of factors, including the natural alternate bearing cycle of olive trees, drought, and heatwaves in Southern Italy.

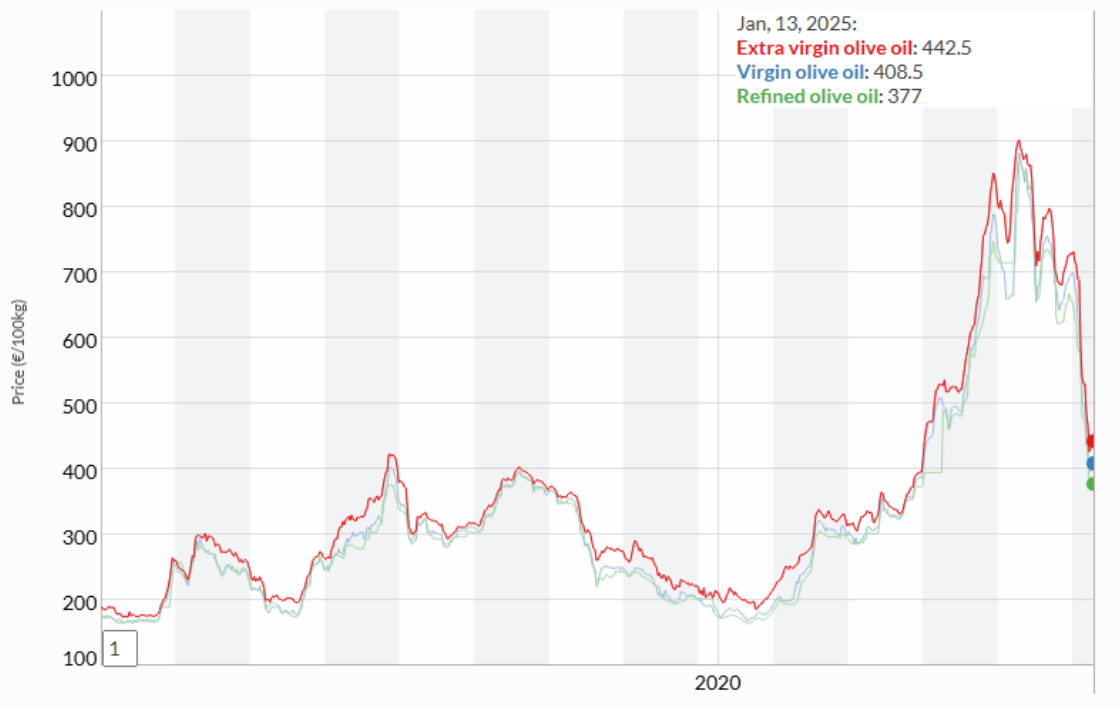
**Figure 18: Olive Oil Production in the EU by Member State (in 1,000 MT)**



Source: International Olive Oil Council data and estimates from FAS offices in Europe.

After hitting historically high prices levels in MY 2022/23 and MY 2023/24 due to a short global supply, producers' (Figure 19) and consumers' (Figure 20) olive oil prices have started easing since spring 2024 in response to favorable conditions for olive oil production in MY 2024/25.

**Figure 19: Extra Virgin Olive Oil Monthly Producers' Prices (in Euro/100 Kg)<sup>16</sup>**

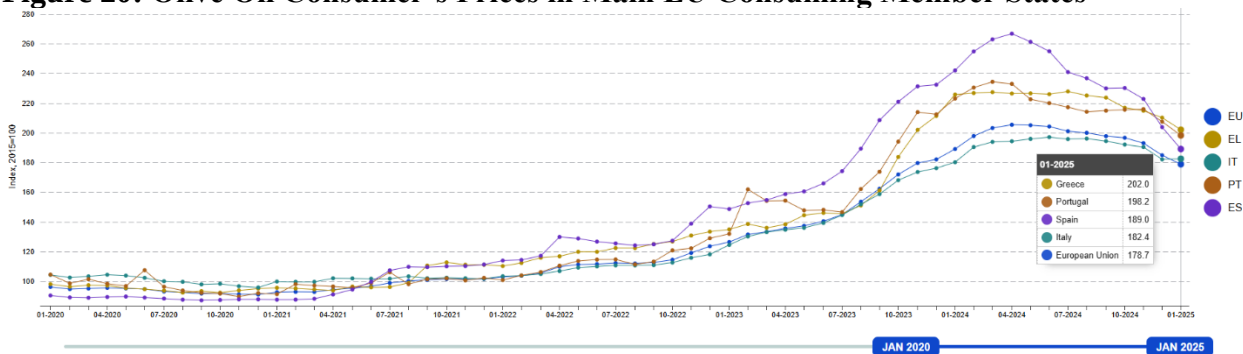


Source: [International Olive Council](#).<sup>17</sup> (from October 2011 to January 2025)

## Consumption

Post anticipates lower prices will help EU consumption recover in MY 2024/25, driven by increased sales in non-producing EU Member States, where olive oil demand is more elastic, and in producing Member States as consumer prices become more affordable.

**Figure 20: Olive Oil Consumer's Prices in Main EU Consuming Member States**



Source: [Food price monitoring tool \(europa.eu\)](#).<sup>18</sup>

<sup>16</sup> Jaén in Spain, Bari in Italy, Chania in Greece, and Tras-os-Montes in Portugal are the most representative olive oil markets of the European Union.

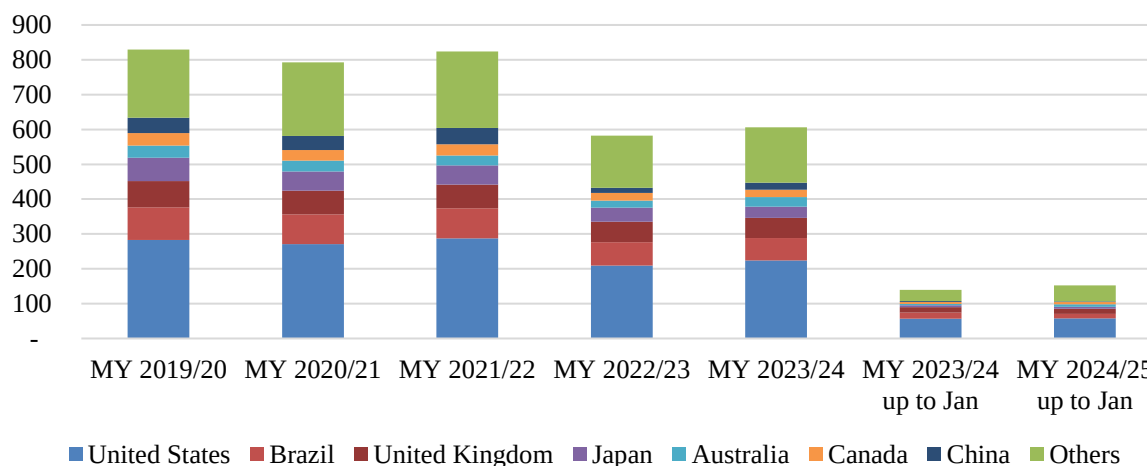
<sup>17</sup> <https://www.internationaloliveoil.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/IOC-prices-rev-0-1-2324.html#ja%C3%A9n-bari-chania-and-tr%C3%A1s-os-montes-extra-virgin-olive-oil>

<sup>18</sup> <https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/cache/website/economy/food-price-monitoring/>

## Trade

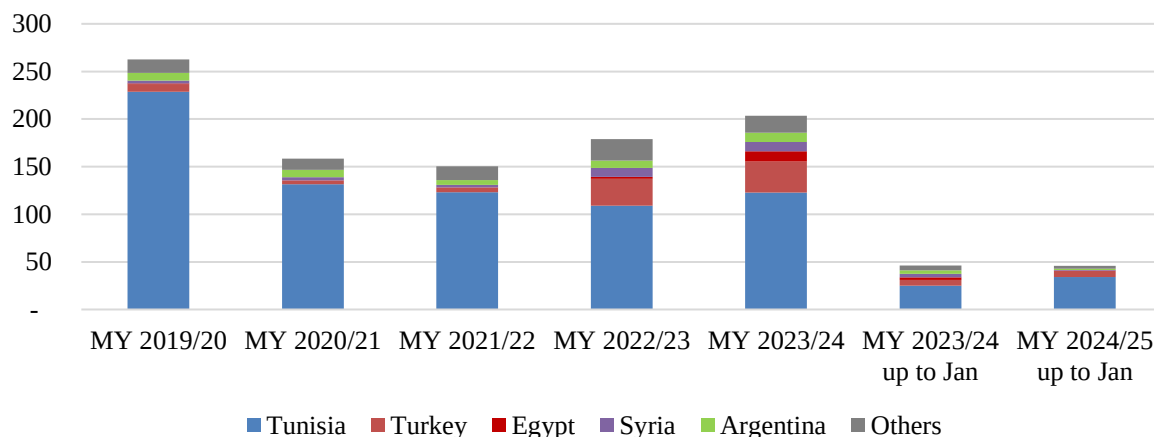
EU imports from Tunisia<sup>19</sup> increased significantly during the first three months of MY 2024/24. Greater olive oil availability from non-EU Mediterranean producers is expected to allow for increased EU imports in MY 2024/25 (Figure 21). Similarly, the projected recovery in EU olive oil output is expected to result in EU exports bouncing back to historical levels. During the two past two consecutive seasons, MY 2022/23 and MY 2023/24, EU olive oil exports were negatively impacted by drought and soaring prices. The United States, followed by Brazil, the United Kingdom, Japan, Canada and China remain the main export markets for EU olive oil.

**Figure 21: EU Exports of Olive Oil by Destination (in MT)**



Source: TDM

**Figure 22: EU Imports of Olive Oil by Origin (in MT)**



Source: TDM

<sup>19</sup> The 56.7 TMT **Error! Hyperlink reference not valid.** was fully allocated during the first tender in January 2025 (see [Policy Section](#) for additional details).

## Stocks

Given improved domestic production, olive oil stocks in the EU are anticipated to bounce back to average levels at the end of MY 2024/25.

## 12. Policy

### Deforestation-free supply chains (EUDR)

As part of the Green Deal, the EC adopted [Regulation 2023/1115](#)<sup>20</sup> aimed to prevent products causing deforestation from entering the EU market. The Regulation targets products which are identified by the EC as the main drivers of deforestation including soybean, palm oil and related products.

**Table 23: Products covered by the EU Deforestation Regulation**

| Commodity | HS Codes in the scope of the proposal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Oil palm  | 1511 Palm oil and its fractions, whether or not refined, but not chemically modified<br>1207 10 Palm nuts and kernels<br>1513 21 Crude palm kernel and babassu oil and fractions thereof<br>1513 29 Palm kernel and babassu oil and their fractions, whether or not refined, but not chemically modified (excluding Crude oil)<br>2306 60 Oilcake and other solid residues of palm nuts or kernels, whether or not ground or in the form of pellets, resulting from the extraction of palm nuts oils or kernels oils<br>382319 fatty acids, industrial, monocarboxylic; acid oils from refining (excl. stearic acid, oleic acid and tall oil fatty acids)<br>291590 saturated acyclic monocarboxylic acids, their anhydrides, halides, peroxides and peroxyacids; their halogenated, sulphonated, nitrated or nitrosated derivatives (excl. formic acid and acetic acid, mono-, di- or trichloroacetic acids, propionic acid, butanoic and pentanoic acids, palmitic and stearic acids, their salts and esters, and acetic anhydride)<br>382370 fatty alcohols, industrial<br>382311 stearic acid, industrial<br>290545 glycerol<br>291570 palmitic acid, stearic acid, their salts and esters<br>382312 oleic acid, industrial |

<sup>20</sup> [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=uriserv%3AOJ.L\\_.2023.150.01.0206.01.ENG&toc=OJ%3AL%3A2023%3A150%3ATOC](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=uriserv%3AOJ.L_.2023.150.01.0206.01.ENG&toc=OJ%3AL%3A2023%3A150%3ATOC)

|      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Soya | 1201 Soya beans, whether or not broken<br>1208 10 Soya bean flour and meal<br>1507 Soya-bean oil and its fractions, whether or not refined, but not chemically modified<br>2304 Oilcake and other solid residues, whether or not ground or in the form of pellets, resulting from the extraction of soya-bean oil |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

To sell any of the covered products in the EU or export them from the EU, business operators will be required to provide extensive information about the product’s origins, including the precise location(s) and general time of production. The Regulation establishes a country benchmarking system through which the EU Commission will assess the risk that countries, or parts thereof, produce relevant commodities and products that contribute to deforestation. Products sourced from standard- or high-risk origins must comply with additional risk assessment and mitigation procedures. For more information, please see GAIN Report: [European Institutions Finalize Deforestation-Free Supply Chain Regulation](#).

On December 23, 2024, the European Union published [Regulation 2024/3234](#)<sup>21</sup> amending the EU Deforestation Regulation in the Official Journal. This amendment postpones the date of entry into application of the EUDR by one year to December 30, 2025, for most operators and June 30, 2026, for small and medium sized operators. The amendment also stipulates that the benchmarking of countries should be published by June 30, 2025. As part of the postponement, the European Commission also published an official statement in which it commits to analyze, based where appropriate on an impact assessment, additional measures to simplify and reduce the administrative burden in the context of the general review of the Regulation, expected no later than June 30, 2028.

As a first-of-its-kind measure, the full impact of EUDR on soy and palm product trade flows is difficult to fully anticipate, however according to industry sources there are likely to be compliance costs associated with this measure which will make them relatively more expensive compared to non-EUDR-affected alternative commodities.

## Common Agricultural Policy (CAP)

The new EU’s Common Agricultural Policy (CAP) for 2023-2027 was [adopted](#)<sup>22</sup> on December 2, 2021, and published in the Official Journal on December 6, 2021. EU Member States were requested to submit so-called [Strategic Plans](#)<sup>23</sup>, incorporating MS specific goals and initiatives, by the end of 2021. By December 2022, all national strategic plans were approved by the European Commission. The ‘new’ CAP entered into effect January 1, 2023.

In March 2024, following weeks of farmer protests across the European Union demanding less administrative burden and better prices, the European Commission published a legislative proposal to amend certain provisions of the Common Agricultural Policy (CAP). The Commission acknowledged

<sup>21</sup> [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:L\\_202403234](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:L_202403234)

<sup>22</sup> [https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/common-agricultural-policy/cap-overview/cap-2023-27\\_en](https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/common-agricultural-policy/cap-overview/cap-2023-27_en)

<sup>23</sup> [https://commission.europa.eu/food-farming-fisheries/key-policies/common-agricultural-policy/cap-strategic-plans\\_en](https://commission.europa.eu/food-farming-fisheries/key-policies/common-agricultural-policy/cap-strategic-plans_en)

that the first year of implementation of the current CAP made clear that adjustments were necessary to ensure effective implementation of the National Strategic Plans and reduce red tape. The updates to the CAP were adopted in May 2024 and published as [Regulation 2024/1468](#)<sup>24</sup>. For more information, please see GAIN Report: [EU Commission Proposes Common Agricultural Policy Revisions Following Farmer Protests](#).

### Private Storage Aid

[EU delegated regulation 2016/1238](#)<sup>25</sup> lays down common eligibility rules for private storage aid for certain agricultural products including olive oil. The European Commission can provide private storage aid (PSA) for a period of 180 days if there are serious disturbances to the olive oil market in a certain region or if the average price for one or more of the following products is recorded on the market during a two-week period:

- € 1,779/ton for extra virgin olive oil
- € 1,710/ton for virgin olive oil
- € 1,524/ton for pomace olive oil

### **EU Vision for Agriculture and Food**

On February 19, 2025, the European Commission published a Communication to the European Parliament and Council laying down its Vision for Agriculture and Food for the 2024-2029 Von der Leyen II mandate. This document will be the basis of upcoming legislative proposals and other actions taken by the EU executive.

The Vision lays down the need for the EU to ensure “a global level playing field” for its farmers and improve their competitiveness. To do so, the Commission proposes the adoption of mirror clauses, notably with regards to pesticide residues, increased border controls, and the signature of Free Trade Agreements with more trade partners. The Vision calls for boosting domestic production and diversifying import suppliers to reduce strategic dependencies for products like protein-rich animal feed and fertilizers. Domestically, the Commission wants a simplification of the Common Agricultural Policy with a shift toward more incentive-based payments. The Commission also proposes to increase the EU’s agricultural competitiveness via the swift adoption of a regulatory framework for new genomic techniques and a slowdown of the pace of plant protection products bans, if no alternatives exist for farmers.

### **EU Industry Code of Good Labelling Practice for Compound Feed for Food Producing Animals**

The European Feed Manufacturers' Federation (FEFAC) and the organization representing European farmers and European agricultural cooperatives (Copa-Cogeca) have jointly developed a [Code of good labelling practice for compound feed for food producing animals](#). The updated version of the code was endorsed by the European Commission in December 2024.

### **EU Policy Response to the War in Ukraine**

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<sup>24</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32024R1468&qid=1720528109038>

<sup>25</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A02016R1238-20180207>

In February 2022, Russian forces invaded Ukraine, which continues to put pressure on global food security as both countries are major exporters of feed and oilseeds products. The EU oilseeds sector has been impacted by disruption in trade flows and increased input prices, such as energy, fertilizers, and pesticides.

Since the beginning of the war, the EU has tried to respond to the disruptions in the supply chains for agricultural products. For more information about the EU's response until March 2024, please see [GAIN Report European Union: Grain and Feed Annual \(April 2024\)](#).

On June 6, 2024, [Regulation \(EU\) 2024/1392](#)<sup>26</sup> entered into force. The Regulation renews autonomous trade measures (ATM) for Ukraine which suspends all customs duties and quotas for Ukrainian products entering the EU for one more year. The Regulation also includes a safeguard mechanism which obliges the Commission to reintroduce quotas if imports of poultry, eggs, sugar, oats, maize, groats and honey exceed the arithmetic mean of quantities imported in the second half of 2021, in 2022 and in 2023.

### **Increased Tariffs on Russian and Belarusian Goods**

On May 30, 2024, the European Union adopted [Council Regulation \(EU\) 2024/1652](#)<sup>27</sup> which increases tariffs on imports into the EU of soybeans, linseeds, rapeseed, sunflower seeds and other products from Russia and Belarus. In addition, Russia and Belarus will no longer have access to any of the EU's WTO quotas that offer better tariff treatment for some products. These measures concern products originating in or exported directly or indirectly from Russia and Belarus to the EU. They do not affect transit through the EU from both countries to other third countries. These measures entered into force on July 1, 2024.

On January 28, 2025, the European Commission [proposed](#)<sup>28</sup> to increase tariffs by an additional 50 percent on top of the common rate for imports of certain goods originating in or exported directly or indirectly from the Russia and Belarus. The list includes olive oil, palm oil, castor oil, sesame oil and margarine. As part of the proposal, the Commission also proposes to impose tariffs on Russian and Belarussian fertilizers. The EU's imports of urea and nitrogen-based fertilizers from Russia have increased significantly in 2023 and 2024. According to the European Commission, these increased imports could disrupt the EU market and EU fertilizers industry, which is facing difficulties due to high energy prices in the EU. The proposal still needs to be adopted by the Council and the European Parliament.

### **Trade Policy**

#### *EU Retaliatory Tariffs*

On March 12, 2025, the United States imposed tariffs of up to 25% on imports of steel, aluminum, and certain products containing steel and aluminum from the European Union. The European Union is

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<sup>26</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=celex%3A32024R1392>

<sup>27</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1652/oj>

<sup>28</sup> [https://ec.europa.eu/transparency/documents-register/detail?ref=COM\(2025\)34&lang=en](https://ec.europa.eu/transparency/documents-register/detail?ref=COM(2025)34&lang=en)

assessing imposing retaliatory tariffs to a [list of U.S. products](#)<sup>29</sup> including soybeans, rapeseeds, fish oil, groundnut oil, palm oil, sunflower oil and margarine. Please note that the list published by the European Commission is only preliminary and not yet final nor adopted. A final decision is expected by mid-April 2025.

### *EU Free Trade Agreements (FTAs)*

The EU is negotiating and has implemented several FTAs with other countries and regions, which include concessions on oilseeds. Additional information is available on the website of the EC at: <https://ec.europa.eu/trade/policy/countries-and-regions/negotiations-and-agreements/>.

#### New Zealand:

On May 1, 2024, the trade agreement between the European Union and New Zealand entered into force. The trade agreement removes all tariffs at entry into force on EU agri-food exports to New Zealand. However, this is not the case for all agri-food imports into the EU with tariffs rate quotas for some products such as ethanol with 4000 tons at zero duty. More information about the agreement can be found [here](#).<sup>30</sup>

#### Mercosur:

On December 6, 2024, the European Commission [announced](#)<sup>31</sup> that President von der Leyen and her counterparts from four Mercosur countries (Brazilian President Lula, Argentinian President Milei, Paraguayan President Peña, and Uruguayan President Lacalle Pou) finalized negotiations and reached a political agreement for an EU-Mercosur partnership agreement. In 2019, the European Commission had reached a preliminary agreement with Mercosur countries, but amendments were made to several sectors, including agriculture. The agreement includes a bilateral safeguard clause in case increased imports cause - or even threaten to cause - serious injury to relevant sectors, including agricultural sectors. This safeguard clause also covers imports under tariff rate quotas in the agreement. The text still needs to be formally approved by the European Parliament and the EU Member States.

Under the agreement, there is a gradual phase out duties on 91 percent of EU exports to Mercosur and 92 percent of Mercosur exports to the EU. For oilseeds, this includes an elimination of tariffs for EU exports of olive oil to Mercosur countries. Additionally, Mercosur countries will be allocated new TRQs with a 5-year phase in period:

- 450,000 metric tons of ethanol for industrial
- 200,000 metric tons for other uses, including biofuels

#### Mexico:

On January 17, 2025, the EU and Mexico announced the conclusion of a new Free Trade Agreement. As for the agreement with Mercosur, the text still needs to be formally approved by the European Parliament and the EU Member States. The agreement abolishes customs duties for most goods,

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<sup>29</sup> <https://circabc.europa.eu/ui/group/e9d50ad8-e41f-4379-839a-fdfe08f0aa96/library/9f483239-477f-4f14-8e2a-a09e1edb1f3d/details?download=true>

<sup>30</sup> [https://policy.trade.ec.europa.eu/eu-trade-relationships-country-and-region/countries-and-regions/new-zealand/eu-new-zealand-agreement\\_en](https://policy.trade.ec.europa.eu/eu-trade-relationships-country-and-region/countries-and-regions/new-zealand/eu-new-zealand-agreement_en)

<sup>31</sup> [https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/en/ip\\_24\\_6244](https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/en/ip_24_6244)



including agricultural products. Olive oil for example, will move from 20 percent tariffs on EU imports into Mexico to 0 percent.

Additionally, Mexico will be allocated new TRQs with a 5-year phase in period:

- 7000 metric tons of ethanol for the production of spirit drinks
- 18000 metric tons of ethanol for other uses (CN codes (22071000, 22072000, 22089099))

### *Boeing Case*

On November 9, 2020, the European Union announced retaliatory tariffs against U.S. exports following the World Trade Organization's (WTO) ruling that authorized the EU to take such countermeasures due to U.S. subsidies to aircraft maker Boeing. The European Commission published [Implementing Regulation 2020/1646](#)<sup>32</sup> that outlined the list of products subjected to a 25 percent additional tariff. The Regulation entered into force on November 10, 2020. Groundnuts as well as crude fixed vegetable fats and oils were included. In June 2021, the European Union and the United States reached an understanding in the large civil aircraft dispute. On July 9, 2021, the European Commission adopted [Implementing Regulation 2021/1123](#)<sup>33</sup> suspending the application of tariffs until July 11, 2026.

### *Duty-Free Quota for Olive Oil*

In accordance with the Euro-Mediterranean Agreement, a 56,700 MT duty-free quota is open for Tunisian virgin olive oil imports into the European Union. Additional information on this regime is available in the [Commission Implementing Regulation \(EU\) 2020/761](#). Outside quota or preferential agreements, olive oil imports to the EU are subject to a 124.50 Euros/100 Kg duty.

### **Aid System for Oilseeds**

Farmers do not receive specific payments for growing oilseeds. Except for the olive sector, there is no intervention (i.e., buying, export subsidy or other market support programs) available for oilseeds in the EU. See the olive oil section for additional information.

### **Blair House Agreement**

The 1992 Blair House Memorandum of Understanding on Oilseeds (or Blair House Agreement (BHA)) between the United States and the EU was included in the EU WTO schedule of commitments and resolved a General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade dispute over EU domestic support programs that impaired U.S. access to the EU oilseeds market. As noted earlier, there are no crop specific payments for oilseeds-- the BHA is maintained but not in use.

### **EU Energy Policy and the Renewable Energy Directive**

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<sup>32</sup> [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg\\_impl/2020/1646/oj](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg_impl/2020/1646/oj)

<sup>33</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/en/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32021R1123>

In December 2018, the EU published the Renewable Energy Directive II (REDII) in the Official Journal ([Directive 2018/2001](#)<sup>34</sup>). REDII was revised in 2023 to account for the EU's new greenhouse gas emission reduction targets. A revised version of REDII entered into force on November 20, 2023, with an 18-month period to transpose most of the Directive's provisions into national law in the Member States.

The revised REDII sets out an overall renewable energy target of at least 42.5 percent renewables binding at EU level by 2030. For transport, Member States can choose between a target of reducing greenhouse gas (GHG) intensity by 14.5 percent up to 2030 or ensuring a share of at least 29 percent of renewables in final energy consumption by 2030. The Directive also sets out a binding target on non-crop based advanced biofuels of 1 percent in 2025 and 5.5 percent in 2030, of which a share of at least 1 percentage point is from renewable fuels of non-biological origin in 2030. The EU capped crop-based biofuels at the level consumed in each Member State in 2020, with an additional 1 percent point allowed over present consumption up to an overall cap of 7 percent.

REDII puts in place a freeze on the use of high-risk indirect land use change (ILUC) biofuels at 2019 levels and a requirement to phase them out completely by 2030. In May 2019, the European Commission adopted [Delegated Regulation 2019/807](#)<sup>35</sup> setting out specific criteria on what the EU considers a high-risk ILUC biofuel. The Commission determined that high ILUC-risk biofuel feedstocks are those for which the share of production expansion into land with high carbon stock is higher than 10 percent since 2008 and with an annual expansion of more than 1 percent. Given the calculations of the Commission, only palm oil falls under this definition and will need to be phased out by 2030. Soy, rapeseed, and sunflower do not fall under this definition. However, the Delegated Act gives the possibility for producers, including palm producers, to certify their feedstock as low-risk ILUC through additional measures. Delegated Regulation 2019/807 also stipulates that the Commission shall review all relevant aspects of the report on feedstock expansion. This could lead to more commodities falling under the definition of a 'high-risk ILUC biofuel' in the future.

REDII also sets out sustainability criteria for biofuels to count toward the mandatory national renewable targets for transport fuels. The criteria include greenhouse gas savings, exclusion for land with high biodiversity value and high carbon stock, and measures to mitigate ILUC. REDII requires all biofuel used in the EU, whether produced in the EU or a third country, to demonstrably meet these criteria through compliance certification. In January 2019, the European Commission recognized the U.S. soy industry's scheme certifying U.S. soybeans compliance. With this recognition, certified U.S. soybeans can be used for biofuel production in the EU and count towards the RED targets. There are currently over a dozen other certification schemes recognized by the EU.

## **EU Plant Protection Products Policy**

Plant protection products (PPPs) along with Maximum Residue Limits (MRLs) and import tolerances, are an increasingly important issue in the EU since there is a significant reduction in the number of active substances approved for use. [Regulation \(EC\) No 1107/2009](#)<sup>36</sup> and [Regulation \(EC\) No](#)

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<sup>34</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX:02018L2001-20231120>

<sup>35</sup> [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=uriserv:OJ.L\\_.2019.133.01.0001.01.ENG&toc=OJ:L:2019:133:FULL](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=uriserv:OJ.L_.2019.133.01.0001.01.ENG&toc=OJ:L:2019:133:FULL)

<sup>36</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A02009R1107-20221121&qid=1708439066593>

[396/2005](#)<sup>37</sup> regulate PPPs and MRLs, respectively. There is a regular review of active substances for which the approval is up for renewal, as well as their associated MRLs. Existing MRLs are also being reviewed through a process known as an ‘Article 12’ review. The link refers to a list indicating the upcoming MRL reviews under this Article 12 process. It is important to note that this list is not all-inclusive. Stakeholders are encouraged to actively engage early on in these review processes by reaching out to the applicant. Together with the applicant, they can ensure that the necessary data is available for review or if trials for data collection are in progress or should be initiated etc., especially if the substance is not used or authorized in the EU. Stakeholders are encouraged to engage with FAS on substances and MRLs of importance to their commodities and to check the USEU website for updates of the EU Early Alert.

EU Restrictions on the Use of Neonicotinoids: The EU has prohibited the use of three neonicotinoids (clothianidin, imidacloprid, and thiamethoxam) except for their application in permanent greenhouses since 2018, while a fourth one was banned in 2020 (thiacloprid). [Commission Regulation \(EU\) 2023/334](#)<sup>38</sup> reduces the current EU maximum residue limits (MRLs) for clothianidin and thiamethoxam to the limit of determination (LOD) and will apply as of March 7, 2026. Imported products will then no longer be able to contain residues of these two neonicotinoids. The proposed reduction in MRLs is based on a stated interest in protecting pollinators in countries outside of the EU and is not related to food safety concerns.

Glyphosate: [Commission Implementing Regulation \(EU\) 2023/2660](#)<sup>39</sup> renewed the approval of the active substance glyphosate for 10 years, until December 15, 2033. The renewal is subject to certain new conditions and restrictions, such as the prohibition of pre-harvest use as a desiccant and the need for certain measures to protect non-target organisms. The placing on the market of plant protection products containing the active substance remains under the responsibility of Member States.

## **Agricultural Biotechnology**

In the EU, the authorization for the cultivation of genetically engineered (GE) crops is governed by [Directive 2001/18/EC](#)<sup>40</sup>. However, GE crop cultivation remains highly limited. The only GE crop approved for cultivation is corn MON 810, which is grown exclusively in Spain and Portugal, accounting for just 1 percent of the total EU corn area. Additionally, since 2015, 19 EU countries have opted out of GE crop cultivation under [Directive \(EU\) 2015/412](#)<sup>41</sup>. For the import, distribution, or processing of GE crops, [Regulation \(EC\) No 1829/2003](#)<sup>42</sup> outlines the authorization process. Imported GE crops are predominantly used as animal feed, which must be labeled as "contains GE products." For the import, distribution, or processing of GE crops, [Regulation \(EC\) No 1829/2003](#)<sup>43</sup> sets out the authorization process. Imported GE crops are predominantly used as animal feed, which must be labeled as "contains GE products." The EU imports both GE rapeseed and rapeseed meal and given its protein

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<sup>37</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A02005R0396-20231021&qid=1708439107170>

<sup>38</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32023R0334&qid=1708439162377>

<sup>39</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32023R2660&qid=1708439196867>

<sup>40</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:02001L0018-20210327&from=EN>

<sup>41</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32015L0412>

<sup>42</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:02003R1829-20210327&qid=1639496166824&from=EN>

<sup>43</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:02003R1829-20210327&qid=1639496166824&from=EN>

deficiency as well as over 30 million metric tons (MT) of soybeans and soybean meal, the majority of which are GE. For more information, please see the [EU Biotechnology and Other New Production Technologies Annual Report](#).

**Maximum Levels of Nickel**

In February 2024, the EU agreed to establish maximum levels for nickel in oilseeds used as food. These levels will apply from July 1, 2025, onwards. Oilseeds put on the market before that date may remain on the market until their minimum durability or use-by data. The newly established levels will be published as an amendment to [Commission Regulation \(EU\) 2023/915 of 25 April 2023 on maximum levels for certain contaminants in food](#).<sup>44</sup> The Annex to this legislation will include the following addition:

**Table 24: Products covered by the new maximum levels of nickel**

| Product        | Maximum level of nickel (mg/kg) |
|----------------|---------------------------------|
| Sunflower seed | 8,0                             |
| Peanuts        | 12                              |
| Soybeans       | 15                              |

Please note that the maximum level does not apply to oilseeds for crushing and oil refining, provided that the remaining pressed oilseeds are not placed on the market as food.

**Related Reports**

For related reports please search the USDA/FAS GAIN database:  
<https://gain.fas.usda.gov/>

<sup>44</sup> <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32023R0915&qid=1710321006917>

**Attachments:**

No Attachments